THE FIRST-TRY

EDIBLE CANDLE COOKBOOK

150 Tested Butter, Chocolate & Cheese Candles That Hold Their Shape, with a Food-Safe Wick Guide, Troubleshooting Chart and Holiday Party Plans

MARGOT ELLERY

The First-Try Edible Candle Cookbook

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Safety notice. Edible candles involve an open flame and hot fat. Never leave a lit candle unattended, keep candles away from children, pets and flammable materials, and follow the safety guidance in Part One. Use only untreated 100% cotton wicks, and always remove the wick and the butter immediately around it before eating.

Allergy and food safety notice. Recipes may contain dairy, nuts, sesame, gluten, eggs, soy, fish and other allergens. Check every ingredient label and inform your guests. Candles made with fresh ingredients, cheese or meat are perishable and must be refrigerated as directed.

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A Note from Margot

The first butter candle I ever made collapsed in front of eleven dinner guests.

It had looked perfect in the fridge: a tall golden pillar flecked with rosemary, a little cotton wick standing proudly in the middle. I carried it to the table inside a hollowed sourdough loaf, lit it, and stepped back to enjoy the gasps. They came, briefly. Then the candle leaned. Then it slumped. The rosemary around the wick began to smoke, and within ten minutes my showpiece looked like a melted snowman in a bread bowl. Everyone was very kind about it. I was mortified.

So I did what home cooks do. I went back to the kitchen and started taking notes. I learned that butter straight from the store behaves very differently from butter that has been softened to the right temperature. I learned that herbs and cheese packed right up against a wick are what cause sputtering and smoke, and that a simple column of clarified butter around the wick fixes it completely. I learned which molds release cleanly, how long a candle really needs to chill, how warm a room can be before a candle starts to lean, and which wicks belong anywhere near food (and which never do).

This book is everything I wish I'd had that night. Every recipe in it is written around one promise: **it should work the first time.** That means exact weights alongside cup measures, real temperatures instead of "softened," honest chilling times, and a clear plan for what to do if something goes sideways. It also means safety comes first, not as an afterthought in the back of the book.

Inside you'll find 150 edible candles: salty, herby, garlicky, cheesy, smoky, spiced, sweet and chocolatey, plus a full chapter of dairy-free candles so everyone at the table can dip. You'll also find the breads, boards and bowls that turn a single candle into a centerpiece, and complete party plans for the holidays and every celebration in between.

An edible candle is a small piece of theater. It makes people lean in, reach for the same loaf, and talk to each other. That, more than anything, is why I love making them. I hope this book gives you the confidence to light your first one, and to get it right on the very first try.

With butter and warm wishes,

MARGOT ELLERY

How to Use This Book

Start with Part One

Please don't skip it. Part One, *The First-Try Method,* is short, and it is the reason the recipes work. It explains the four shaping methods used throughout the book, how to choose and prime a wick, the exact temperatures that matter, how much of any mix-in a candle can hold, and how to burn and serve an edible candle safely. Every recipe refers back to it.

The anatomy of a recipe

Each candle recipe in Part Two follows the same layout, so you always know where to look:

- **Recipe number.** Recipes are numbered 1 to 150 for easy reference. The indexes at the back of the book use these numbers.
- **At a glance.** Yield, method, active time, chill time and approximate burn time.
- **Diet labels.** Quick tags for vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free and nut-free candles (see the key below).
- **Ingredients.** US measures first, metric weights in brackets. If you own a kitchen scale, use the grams: they are the single best way to guarantee a first-try result.
- **Method.** Numbered steps, written in the order you'll actually do them.
- **First-Try Tip.** The one detail that makes the biggest difference for that specific recipe.
- **Pair It With.** The breads and dippers that suit the candle best.
- **Serve It.** How to present it, and what to put around it.
- **Make Ahead & Storage.** How far ahead you can make it, and how to store it before and after lighting.

The standard candle

Unless a recipe says otherwise, every candle in this book is made in the **standard mold**: a 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) paper or silicone cup, about 3 to 3½ in (8 to 9 cm) across, filled to about ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. One standard candle uses about 1 cup (227 g) of fat and serves 6 to 8 people as a dip alongside bread. The *Sizing & Scaling* chart at the end of Part One shows how to make minis, pillars and centerpiece candles from any recipe.

Diet labels

Label	Meaning
V	Vegetarian: no meat, fish or meat-based fat. Choose vegetarian versions of hard cheeses (see Chapter 4).
GF	Gluten-free as written. Always check labels on spice blends, miso and sauces, and serve with gluten-free bread.
DF	Dairy-free: no butter, ghee, cheese or milk products.

Label	Meaning
NF	Nut-free as written. Coconut is not counted as a tree nut here; check with your guests.

> **A NOTE ON ALLERGENS** Edible candles are shared food, and guests dip into the same pool. When you are hosting, list the main ingredients on a small card next to each candle, especially nuts, dairy, sesame and gluten, and keep a dairy-free or nut-free candle on a separate board with its own bread.

PART ONE

The First-Try Method

Why Edible Candles Fail (and How This Book Fixes It)

Almost every failed edible candle fails for one of five reasons. Once you know them, they are easy to avoid, and every recipe in this book is built to avoid them.

1. **The butter was the wrong temperature.** Butter that is too cold won't pack, so it traps air pockets that later cause cracks and collapses. Butter that is too warm turns greasy, separates and never sets cleanly. The fix: soften butter to 65 to 68°F (18 to 20°C). It should hold a fingerprint without looking shiny.
2. **The candle wasn't chilled long enough.** A candle that feels firm on the outside can still be soft in the center. The fix: honest chilling times, and a simple skewer test before you unmold.
3. **There was too much mix-in, or the wrong kind.** Wet ingredients like honey, sauces and fresh fruit make butter weep and slump. Too much cheese or chopped herbs leaves too little fat to hold the shape. The fix: the *Mix-In Rules* chart, and freeze-dried fruit, powders and reductions in place of anything watery.
4. **The wick was wrong, or it touched the mix-ins.** Craft wicks are often waxed or metal-cored, and a wick surrounded by herbs, cheese or sugar will sputter, smoke and burn unevenly. The fix: untreated 100% cotton wicks, primed in clarified butter, and the *Clean-Burn Core* method for any candle with chunky mix-ins.
5. **The room was too warm.** Butter begins to soften around 70°F (21°C). A candle carried to a warm table and left for an hour will lean. The fix: keep candles cold until just before serving, light them within 10 minutes of leaving the fridge, and plan to enjoy them within the hour.

Your Edible Candle Pantry: The Fats

The fat is the candle. It is what holds the shape, what feeds the flame, and what you dip your bread into. Each fat behaves differently, and choosing the right one is the first step to a candle that works.

Fat	Firmness when chilled	Flavor	How it burns	Best for
Unsalted butter	Firm	Clean, sweet, creamy	Steady, small flame	Every recipe: lets you control the salt
Salted butter	Firm	Rich, savory	Steady	Simple savory candles
European-style or cultured butter (82 to 86% fat)	Firm, very smooth	Deeper, slightly tangy	Very steady, less spitting	Premium candles, gifting
Clarified butter or ghee	Firm when cold, grainy at room temperature	Nutty, toasty	The cleanest burn of all	The Clean-Burn Core, poured candles
Beef tallow	Very firm	Savory, beefy	Strong, steady	Smoky and steakhouse candles
Bacon fat, duck fat	Medium	Smoky or rich	Steady	Blended with butter in smoky candles

Fat	Firmness when chilled	Flavor	How it burns	Best for
Food-grade cocoa butter (deodorized)	Very firm	Neutral or lightly chocolatey	Steady	Firming any candle for warm rooms; chocolate and dairy-free candles
Refined coconut oil	Firm in the fridge, soft at room temperature	Neutral	Steady	Dairy-free candles, always blended with cocoa butter
Plant-based butter sticks (block style)	Medium-firm	Buttery	Steady	Dairy-free candles that work like butter

> **CHOOSING BUTTER** Use stick or block butter, never whipped butter or butter spread from a tub: both contain air or extra water and will not hold a shape. Any good grocery-store butter works. Higher-fat European-style butter gives a smoother, glossier candle and spits less as it melts, so it's worth buying for candles you'll gift or serve to guests.

HOW TO CLARIFY BUTTER

You'll use clarified butter for the Clean-Burn Core, for priming wicks, and for poured candles. Make a jar at a time; it keeps for 3 months in the fridge.

1. Melt 1 lb (454 g) unsalted butter in a small saucepan over low heat. Let it bubble gently, without stirring, for 8 to 10 minutes, until the foam on top thins and the milk solids at the bottom turn pale golden.
2. Skim off the foam with a spoon.
3. Line a sieve with a paper towel or cheesecloth, set it over a heatproof jar, and slowly pour the butter through, leaving the solids behind.
4. Cool, cover and refrigerate. You'll have about 1½ cups (340 g).

For **ghee**, keep cooking in step 1 until the solids turn light brown and smell nutty, about 5 minutes longer, then strain. Store-bought ghee works perfectly in every recipe that calls for clarified butter.

Tools & Molds

You don't need anything special to start: a paper cup, a chopstick and some cotton string will make a beautiful candle. These are the tools that make the process easier and the results more reliable.

ESSENTIAL

- **Digital kitchen scale.** The most important tool in this book. Weighing butter and mix-ins takes the guesswork out completely.
- **Instant-read thermometer.** For softening butter, pouring cores and tempering chocolate.
- **Mixing bowl and flexible spatula,** or a stand mixer with the paddle attachment for large batches.
- **Molds** (see below).
- **Wooden chopstick or bamboo skewer,** for making the wick channel.
- **Food-safe wick** (see *The Food-Safe Wick Guide*).
- **Clothespin, binder clip or two skewers,** for holding a wick upright while a poured candle sets.

- **Small offset spatula or butter knife,** for smoothing the top.
- **Heatproof serving plate, board or bread bowl.**
- **Long lighter or long matches, and a candle snuffer** (or a small metal spoon).

HELPFUL

- **Wide smoothie straws** (plastic or metal, about ½ in / 12 mm across), for the Clean-Burn Core.
- **Piping bag,** for filling tall or shaped molds without air pockets.
- **Parchment paper,** for lining molds and wrapping finished candles.
- **Silicone pillar, sphere, heart and cone molds** for shaped and holiday candles.

MOLDS AT A GLANCE

Mold	Size	What it makes	Notes
Paper cup (standard)	10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml)	Standard candle, serves 6 to 8	Cheap, easy, tears away cleanly. Use plain unwaxed or lightly coated cups.
Paper espresso cup or silicone votive	3 to 4 oz (90 to 120 ml)	Mini candle, serves 2	Perfect for place settings and tasting flights.
Tall silicone pillar mold	20 to 24 oz (600 to 700 ml)	Pillar candle, serves 12 to 16	Use the Clean-Burn Core for every pillar.
Shaped silicone molds	Varies	Hearts, spheres, trees, stars	Flexible molds release best. Chill an extra 30 minutes.
Small ramekin or tin	6 to 8 oz (180 to 240 ml)	Candle served in its vessel	Not unmolded: the candle burns down inside. Good for soft fats.
Clean food can or ring mold	Varies	Wide, short candles	Line with parchment for easy release.

The Food-Safe Wick Guide

The wick is the part of an edible candle that you don't eat, but it sits in your food, so it matters more than anything else. There is no official "food-safe wick" certification. What you want is a wick made of nothing but plain cotton, with nothing added.

USE

- **Untreated, unwaxed 100% cotton braided wick** about ⅛ in (3 mm) thick, sold by the spool as "pure cotton wick," "raw cotton wick" or "unwaxed cotton wick." This is the best choice.
- **Plain, unbleached 100% cotton kitchen twine** (butcher's string): the same string you'd tie a roast with. It burns a little faster but works well.

NEVER USE

- Pre-waxed or pre-tabbed craft candle wicks (they are coated in paraffin or other waxes).
- Wicks with a zinc, metal or paper core.
- Twine or string that is dyed, blended with synthetic fibers, or of unknown material.
- Wooden candle wicks.

HOW TO PRIME A WICK

An unprimed cotton wick is limp, burns too fast and can flare. Priming it in clarified butter makes it stiff, so it's easy to insert, and helps it draw up fat steadily.

1. Cut wicks about 1 in (2.5 cm) longer than the height of your mold.
2. Dip each wick in warm melted clarified butter for 30 seconds, until fully saturated.
3. Pull it straight between your fingertips, lay it flat on parchment and chill for 5 minutes.
4. Dip again, straighten and chill. Repeat once more: three coats in all.
5. Store primed wicks flat in a container in the fridge for up to 1 month.

> **WICK LENGTH** Every recipe uses the same rule: push the wick down to within ½ in (12 mm) of the bottom of the candle, and trim the top to ¼ in (6 mm) above the surface just before lighting. A longer wick makes a tall, smoky flame; a shorter one may drown in the melting pool.

Temperature Is Everything

These are the temperatures that matter. Keep this chart handy until you know it by heart.

Stage	Temperature	What it looks like
Softened butter for packing	65 to 68°F (18 to 20°C)	Holds a fingerprint, still matte, not shiny or greasy
Melted chocolate before mixing in	88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C)	Fluid, feels just cool against your lip
Clarified butter for the core	95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C)	Fully liquid, barely warm to the touch
Poured candles (ghee, tallow, cocoa butter blends)	100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C)	Liquid, just starting to turn cloudy at the edges
Fridge for chilling	35 to 40°F (2 to 4°C)	A normal refrigerator
The ideal serving room	Below 72°F (22°C)	Candles hold shape for about an hour

> **SOFTENING BUTTER, FAST** Cut cold butter into ½ in (12 mm) cubes and leave them spread out on a plate for 20 to 30 minutes. Never microwave butter for candles: it melts unevenly, and partially melted butter will not set to the same firm, smooth texture.

The Four Methods

Every candle in this book is made with one of four methods. Each recipe tells you which one to use and gives you the full steps, but here is why each exists.

METHOD 1: DIRECT WICK

For candles where the butter contains only fine ingredients: salt, ground spices, finely grated zest, powders. Softened butter is packed into the mold, a channel is made with a chopstick, and the primed wick goes straight in. It's the fastest method and the place to start.

METHOD 2: CLEAN-BURN CORE

This is the technique that makes this book different. Herbs, garlic, cheese, sugar and chocolate are delicious in the butter, but next to the wick they scorch, smoke and make the flame sputter. So instead of placing the wick into flavored butter, we build a column of pure clarified butter down the center of the candle and set the wick inside it.

1. Grease a wide straw and stand it in the center of the empty mold.
2. Pack the flavored butter around the straw and chill until firm.
3. Twist the straw out, leaving a clean channel.
4. Stand the primed wick in the channel and fill it with barely warm clarified butter.
5. Chill until the core is set.

The flame burns only clean fat; the flavored butter around it melts into the pool and into your bread. Chunky mix-ins never touch the wick. Use the Clean-Burn Core for any candle with fresh herbs, garlic, cheese, sugar, chocolate, meat or nuts, and for every pillar.

METHOD 3: LAYERED

Two or three flavors stacked in bands, built with a Clean-Burn Core running through all of them. Each layer is chilled briefly before the next goes on, so the lines stay sharp. Layered candles take longer, but they are the showpieces of the book.

METHOD 4: POURED

For candles made from fats that are poured rather than packed: ghee, tallow, duck fat, and cocoa butter blends. The fat is melted with its flavorings, cooled to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C), and poured around a wick held upright with a clip. Poured candles set very firm and burn especially cleanly.

> **THE SKEWER TEST** Before unmolding any candle, push a thin skewer into the side, about halfway down. If it meets firm resistance all the way, the candle is ready. If it slides in easily near the center, chill for another 30 minutes.

Mix-In Rules

These are the limits that keep a standard candle (1 cup / 227 g fat) firm, smooth and burning cleanly. Stay inside them and you can invent your own flavors with confidence.

Mix-in	Maximum per standard candle	Notes
Salt, ground spices, dried herb powders	1 tablespoon total	Direct Wick is fine.
Dried herbs (leafy), seeds, cracked pepper	2 tablespoons	Clean-Burn Core if pieces are large.
Fresh herbs, finely chopped	3 tablespoons	Pat completely dry before chopping. Clean-Burn Core.
Fresh garlic or shallot, minced	1 tablespoon raw, or 6 roasted cloves	Clean-Burn Core. Refrigerate; see storage.
Hard cheese, finely grated (Parmesan, Pecorino, aged Cheddar)	½ cup (45 g)	Grate on the fine holes. Clean-Burn Core.

Mix-in	Maximum per standard candle	Notes
Soft or crumbly cheese (blue, goat, feta)	2 oz (56 g)	Crumbled small and chilled. Clean-Burn Core.
Pastes (miso, harissa, pesto, gochujang)	2 tablespoons	Beat in thoroughly. Clean-Burn Core.
Liquid sweeteners (honey, maple syrup)	2 tablespoons	Beat in a little at a time so it doesn't weep.
Sugar (always powdered or superfine)	3 tablespoons	Granulated sugar stays gritty.
Freeze-dried fruit, ground to powder	½ cup whole fruit (about 10 g)	The secret to bright fruit flavor with no water.
Melted chocolate	3 oz (85 g), replacing ¼ cup of the butter	Cool to 88 to 90°F first. Clean-Burn Core.
Wine, spirits, juices, sauces	Reduce to 1 tablespoon syrup first	Never add liquids straight in.
Bacon, chorizo, cooked meats	¼ cup (30 g) finely chopped, cooked crisp	Clean-Burn Core. Refrigerate; see storage.

WARM-ROOM INSURANCE Hosting somewhere warm, or outdoors? Replace 2 tablespoons (28 g) of the butter in any recipe with 2 tablespoons (25 g) melted food-grade cocoa butter, beaten in once it cools to 90°F (32°C). The candle tastes the same but stays firm 15 to 20 minutes longer.

Lighting, Burning & Serving Safely

An edible candle is still an open flame. These rules apply to every candle in this book.

BEFORE YOU LIGHT

- Set the candle on a heatproof plate, board, bread bowl or tray with a rim to catch the melting butter.
- Place it on a stable surface, away from curtains, napkins, paper decorations, dried flowers and anything hanging overhead.
- Keep it out of drafts, fans and open windows: moving air makes the flame flicker and the butter melt unevenly.
- Trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm).

WHILE IT BURNS

- **Never leave a lit candle unattended,** and keep it out of reach of children and pets.
- Light it about 10 minutes before you want to start dipping. A pool will form within 10 to 15 minutes.
- Dip from the outer edge of the pool, away from the flame. Use bread, crackers or a spoon, never fingers.
- If the flame grows taller than about 1 in (2.5 cm) or begins to smoke, snuff it, trim the wick and relight.
- Plan to enjoy the candle within about an hour of taking it out of the fridge, and blow it out once the pool reaches about ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom.

WHEN YOU'RE DONE

- Snuff the flame with a candle snuffer or the back of a metal spoon rather than blowing, which can spatter hot butter.
- Let it cool for a few minutes, then pull out and discard the wick.
- Scrape away and discard any butter within ½ in (12 mm) of where the wick stood, and any butter that looks gray or sooty.
- Never relight a candle once it has been put out and cooled; make a fresh one instead.

FOOD SAFETY

- Candles with fresh herbs, garlic, cheese, citrus or meat are perishable. Serve them within 2 hours of taking them out of the fridge, as you would any dairy or meat dish.
- Leftover butter from the pool (well away from the wick) can be scraped into a container, refrigerated and used for cooking within 3 days.
- Fresh garlic in fat must always be kept refrigerated and used within the times given in each recipe.

Troubleshooting Chart

Things still go sideways sometimes, even for professionals. Here's how to fix them, and how to prevent them next time.

Problem	Why it happens	Fix it now	Next time
Candle leans or slumps	Room too warm, candle not fully chilled, or too much mix-in	Return it to the fridge for 20 minutes, then relight	Skewer test before unmolding; light straight from the fridge; use warm-room insurance
Cracks while unmolding	Air pockets, or butter too cold when packed	Smooth the crack with a warm knife; it won't affect burning	Pack in three additions and tap the mold firmly after each
Flame won't stay lit	Wick too short, unprimed or wet, or drowned in the pool	Snuff, pour off a little melted butter, trim the wick to ¼ in and relight	Prime wicks three times; leave ¼ in above the surface
Flame too tall or smoking	Wick too long, or mix-ins touching the wick	Snuff, trim to ¼ in, relight	Use the Clean-Burn Core for any chunky mix-ins
Black flecks in the butter	Soot from a long or crooked wick, or scorched mix-ins	Scrape away the dark area and trim the wick	Trim before lighting; keep the wick centered and straight
Butter weeps or beads of liquid appear	Wet mix-ins (honey, juice, sauce)	Blot with a paper towel and chill	Reduce liquids to syrup; use freeze-dried fruit and powders
Butter is grainy	Butter was too warm or partly melted before packing	It is still safe and tasty; serve as is	Soften to 65 to 68°F; never microwave
Candle sticks to the mold	Mold not lined, or not chilled long enough	Freeze for 10 minutes, then peel or push out	Use paper cups, or line rigid molds with parchment

Problem	Why it happens	Fix it now	Next time
Wick leans to one side	It shifted while the candle set	Straighten it gently with a skewer before lighting	Hold wicks upright with a clip or two skewers
Core and outer butter separate	Core poured too hot	Press the top gently together; it will still burn	Cool clarified butter to 95 to 105°F before pouring

Make Ahead, Storage, Transport & Gifting

MAKING AHEAD

Edible candles are a gift to a busy host because almost all the work happens the day before, or weeks before.

- **Unlit candles, refrigerated:** wrap each candle in parchment, then plastic wrap. Each recipe gives its own fridge time: up to 2 weeks for candles made with only dried ingredients, up to 5 days for candles with fresh herbs, garlic, cheese or citrus, and up to 3 days for candles with meat.
- **Unlit candles, frozen:** wrap well and freeze for up to 3 months (2 months for fresh mix-ins, 1 month for meat). Thaw overnight in the fridge, still wrapped, so condensation doesn't form on the surface.
- **Insert the wick the day you make the candle,** so it sets in place.

TRANSPORTING

Carry candles in a cooler with ice packs, upright in their molds, and unmold at your destination. If the trip is longer than 30 minutes, freeze the candle for an hour first.

GIFTING

An unlit edible candle makes a memorable hostess gift. Unmold it, wrap it in parchment and tie it with kitchen twine, then add a tag with the flavor, the date it was made, a "Keep refrigerated" line, a short list of ingredients and allergens, and these three lighting rules: trim the wick to ¼ in, never leave it unattended, and enjoy it within an hour of lighting.

Sizing & Scaling

Every recipe in this book is written for one standard candle. To make a different size, multiply all the ingredients, including the clarified butter for the core, by the number in the table.

Size	Mold	Multiply recipe by	Serves	Chill time	Approximate burn time
Mini	3 to 4 oz (90 to 120 ml) espresso cup or votive	¼ (makes 1); or use one recipe for 4 minis	2	1 hour	20 to 30 minutes
Standard	10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) cup	1	6 to 8	2 to 3 hours	45 to 60 minutes
Pillar	20 to 24 oz (600 to 700 ml) pillar mold	2	12 to 16	4 hours or overnight	60 to 90 minutes
Centerpiece	Large ring or 32 oz (950 ml) mold, 2 wicks	3 to 4	20 to 30	Overnight	90 minutes or more

BURN TIMES Burn times are approximate and depend on your room, your wick and how much butter your guests dip. Treat them as a guide for planning, not a promise, and always stay with a lit candle.

PART TWO

The Candles

The recipes start here. If this is your very first edible candle, begin with the Classic Sea Salt Butter Candle (recipe 1): it uses the Direct Wick method, takes fifteen minutes of hands-on time, and teaches you everything the other 149 candles build on.

CHAPTER 1

Butter Candle Classics

These are the candles I make most often: simple, quick, and impossible to stop dipping into. Most use the Direct Wick method because their mix-ins are fine enough to sit right up against the flame. Master two or three of them and you'll always have a centerpiece ready for unexpected guests.

RECIPES 1–15

RECIPE 001

V GF NF

Classic Sea Salt Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

This is the candle that started it all, and the one to make first. Good butter, a little flaky salt and nothing else: it lets the bread and the butter shine, and it teaches you the rhythm of packing, wicking and chilling that every other recipe builds on.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 teaspoon flaky sea salt (2 g), plus more for sprinkling
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, beat the butter with a flexible spatula until smooth and creamy, about 1 minute. Beat in the fine sea salt until evenly distributed. Gently fold in the flaky salt so the crystals stay whole.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Use the best butter you can find here; with so few ingredients, it is the flavor. A European-style butter with 82% fat or more gives the smoothest, glossiest finish.

PAIR

Crusty sourdough, a warm baguette, or the No-Knead Crusty Bread Bowl (Bread B1).

SERVE

Sprinkle a few extra flakes of salt on top just after lighting so they glitter in the melting pool. Serve with radishes and cucumber spears for a fresh contrast.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 002

V GF NF

Black Pepper & Flaky Salt Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Coarsely cracked pepper gives this candle a speckled, steakhouse look and a gentle warmth that builds as you dip. It's the one I take to friends who claim they "don't really like" fancy food.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 2 teaspoons black peppercorns (6 g), coarsely cracked
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Crack the peppercorns in a mortar and pestle or under the base of a heavy pan, then sift them through a fine sieve to remove the dusty powder, which can make butter taste bitter.
2. Beat the butter and fine sea salt until smooth. Fold in the cracked pepper and flaky salt.
3. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
4. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Sifting away the pepper dust is the small step that gives this candle a clean, bright pepper flavor and a beautifully speckled finish.

PAIR

Rustic country bread, rye, or warm dinner rolls.

SERVE

Serve alongside a cheese board with aged cheddar and sliced pears.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 003

V GF NF

Cultured Butter & Fleur de Sel Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Cultured butter has a gentle tang, like the butter at a good French bistro. A pinch of fleur de sel brings out its sweetness. This is my "elegant dinner" candle: understated, refined and gone within minutes.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) cultured or European-style unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¾ teaspoon fleur de sel or flaky sea salt (2 g), lightly crushed
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the fine salt until very smooth and creamy, about 1 minute. Fold in the crushed fleur de sel.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Cultured butter softens a little faster than regular butter. Keep this candle in the fridge until 10 minutes before you light it.

PAIR

Thin slices of baguette, buttery crackers, or a sourdough loaf with a dark crust.

SERVE

Serve with a bowl of mixed olives and a chilled glass of white wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 004

V GF NF

Brown Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Browning half the butter turns it nutty, toasty and deeply savory. Whipped back into fresh butter and chilled, it makes a candle that smells like hazelnuts as it melts. The browned bits are the flavor, so we keep them, and the Clean-Burn Core keeps them away from the wick.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, divided
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Cut half the butter (½ cup / 113 g) into cubes and leave it to soften to 65°F (18°C).
2. Melt the remaining ½ cup (113 g) in a small light-colored saucepan over medium heat. Swirl the pan as it foams and cook for 4 to 6 minutes, until the solids at the bottom turn hazelnut brown and it smells nutty. Pour into a bowl, scraping in all the brown bits.
3. Cool the brown butter at room temperature, then chill for 20 to 30 minutes, stirring every 10 minutes, until it is opaque and the texture of soft butter.
4. Beat the brown butter, softened butter and salt together until smooth and evenly golden.
5. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
6. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
7. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The brown butter must be fully cooled and soft-set before you mix it in. If it's even slightly warm, it will melt the fresh butter and the candle will turn out grainy.

PAIR

Sourdough, toasted brioche, or roasted squash wedges.

SERVE

Lovely in autumn with roasted vegetables and a green salad; a pinch of flaky salt on top is all it needs.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 005

V GF NF

Everything Bagel Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sesame, poppy seeds, garlic, onion and salt: everything you love about the bagel, packed into butter. The seeds also give the outside of the candle a wonderful texture. Make it for brunch and watch it disappear.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons everything bagel seasoning (12 g), divided
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g), if your seasoning is unsalted
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter until smooth. Beat in 1 tablespoon of the seasoning (and the salt, if using).
2. Before packing, scatter the remaining ½ tablespoon seasoning inside the empty cup and roll it around so it sticks to the sides once the butter goes in.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** The seeds on the outside are for looks and crunch; the seeds inside carry the flavor. Keeping them away from the wick with the Clean-Burn Core stops sesame from scorching.

PAIR

Toasted bagel chips, rye bread, soft pretzels, or toasted bagel halves cut into strips.

SERVE

Serve at brunch with smoked salmon, cucumber, capers and thinly sliced red onion.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 006

V GF NF

Lemon Pepper Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bright, zesty and a little peppery, this candle wakes up everything it touches. It's as good with bread as it is with grilled shrimp or steamed artichokes, and it's the one I reach for in spring and summer.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- Finely grated zest of 2 lemons (about 2 tablespoons)
- 1½ teaspoons black peppercorns (4 g), finely cracked
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Grate the zest directly over the bowl so you capture the fragrant oils. Add the butter, pepper and salt and beat until smooth and evenly speckled.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Use a fine rasp grater and take only the yellow zest: the white pith beneath is bitter. Fine zest can sit next to the wick; coarse strips can't.

PAIR

Baguette, focaccia, grilled bread, or steamed artichoke leaves.

SERVE

Serve with a platter of grilled shrimp, asparagus and lemon wedges.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 007

V GF NF

Smoked Salt & Paprika Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Smoked salt and smoked paprika give this candle a gentle campfire glow and a beautiful rosy color. It tastes as if it's been near a grill, with no grill involved.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon smoked sea salt (5 g), finely ground
- 2 teaspoons smoked sweet paprika (pimentón dulce) (5 g)
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the smoked salt, paprika and garlic powder until the color is completely even, with no streaks.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Smoked paprika varies a lot in strength. Taste a little of the butter before packing it; you can add up to 1 teaspoon more.

PAIR

Grilled sourdough, cornbread, or potato wedges.

SERVE

Serve with a summer barbecue spread, or alongside grilled corn on the cob for brushing.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 008

V GF NF

Black Truffle Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

A little luxury goes a long way. Store-bought truffle butter or a jar of black truffle paste turns plain butter into something people talk about for weeks. Keep this one for special evenings.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup (57 g) black truffle butter, softened, or 1 tablespoon black truffle paste
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- Freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter, truffle butter (or paste), salt and a few turns of pepper together until completely smooth.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Look for truffle products that list real truffle among the first ingredients. A little truffle salt sprinkled on top before lighting adds an extra burst of aroma.

PAIR

Thin slices of baguette, warm potato bread, or crisp crostini.

SERVE

Serve with a glass of sparkling wine, soft scrambled eggs on toast, or a simple mushroom risotto.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 009

V NF

White Miso Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Miso and butter are one of the great flavor partnerships: salty, savory, rich and a little sweet. This candle tastes deeply satisfying, almost like caramel and cheese at once, without either.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons white (shiro) miso paste (36 g)
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced chives
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, mash the miso with the sesame oil until smooth. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until completely blended. Fold in the chives.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Miso is salty, so don't add salt. Most miso contains no gluten, but some brands use barley; check the label if you need this candle to be gluten-free.

PAIR

Milk bread, sesame flatbread, or rice crackers.

SERVE

Wonderful with steamed corn, roasted sweet potatoes or blanched green beans for dipping.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 010

GF NF

Steakhouse Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Everything that goes on a great steak: garlic, mustard, a splash of Worcestershire and plenty of pepper. Serve it with bread, or let guests spoon the melting butter over slices of grilled steak.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon Worcestershire sauce
- 1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley, patted completely dry
- 1 teaspoon black peppercorns (3 g), coarsely cracked
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, stir together the Worcestershire, mustard and garlic. Add the butter, parsley, pepper and salt and beat until smooth and evenly blended.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Worcestershire sauce contains anchovies, so this candle isn't vegetarian. Choose a gluten-free brand if needed.

PAIR

Garlic bread, crusty ciabatta, or roasted potato wedges.

SERVE

Set it in the middle of a carving board of sliced steak and let everyone spoon the melted butter over their slices.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 011

NF

Furikake & Sesame Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Furikake, the Japanese seaweed and sesame seasoning, gives butter a savory, toasty, ocean-fresh flavor. It's unexpected and completely addictive, especially with warm rice crackers.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons furikake (10 g), divided
- ½ teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the sesame oil, salt and 1½ tablespoons of the furikake until evenly speckled.
2. Scatter the remaining ½ tablespoon furikake around the inside of the empty cup before packing so it coats the outside.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Many furikake blends contain bonito (fish) flakes, and some contain wheat. Choose a vegetarian or gluten-free blend if you need to.

PAIR

Rice crackers, milk bread, or crisp toasted pita.

SERVE

Serve with blanched edamame, cucumber spears and a bowl of steamed rice for the adventurous.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 012

V GF NF

Coriander & Orange Zest Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Toasted coriander seed is floral and citrusy, and orange zest makes it sing. This candle is gentle, fragrant and a lovely surprise with fresh bread and a glass of rosé.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons coriander seeds (4 g)
- Finely grated zest of 1 orange
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Toast the coriander seeds in a dry skillet over medium heat for 1 to 2 minutes, until fragrant. Cool, then grind finely in a mortar and pestle or spice grinder.
2. Beat the butter with the ground coriander, orange zest and salt until smooth.
3. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
4. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Grind the coriander finely: whole or cracked seeds near the wick can pop. If you prefer a coarser texture, switch to the Clean-Burn Core method.

PAIR

Baguette, seeded rye, or carrot and fennel sticks.

SERVE

Serve on a spring board with roasted carrots, goat cheese and a drizzle of honey.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 013

V GF NF

Mustard Seed & Dijon Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Two kinds of mustard make this candle bold and tangy, with little pops of seed in every dip. It's made for pretzels and charcuterie boards.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon whole-grain mustard
- 2 teaspoons Dijon mustard
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 teaspoon honey
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Stir the mustards and honey together in a medium bowl. Add the butter and salt a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until smooth.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Mustard is mostly water, so beat it into the butter gradually. If the mixture starts to look curdled, chill the bowl for 5 minutes, then beat again.

PAIR

Soft pretzels, rye bread, or pumpernickel.

SERVE

The centerpiece of a charcuterie board with ham, salami, pickles and aged cheddar.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 014

V GF

Pink Peppercorn & Lime Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Pink peppercorns are sweet, floral and only gently spicy, and their color is gorgeous against the pale butter. With lime zest, this is a bright, pretty candle for warm-weather parties.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon pink peppercorns (5 g), lightly crushed, plus a few whole ones for the top
- Finely grated zest of 2 limes
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Crush the pink peppercorns between your fingers or with the flat of a knife. Beat the butter with the crushed peppercorns, lime zest and salt until evenly speckled.
2. Once packed and smoothed, press a few whole pink peppercorns lightly into the top, keeping them at least ½ in (12 mm) away from the center.
3. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
4. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pink peppercorns are related to cashews; leave them out (or swap in lime zest only) if any of your guests has a tree-nut allergy.

PAIR

Baguette, grilled flatbread, or corn tortilla chips.

SERVE

Pretty with a summer platter of melon, prosciutto and burrata.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 015

V GF NF

Classic Mini Candle Trio

3 mini candles, serves 6 • Direct Wick (minis) • Active 25 minutes • Chill 1 hour • Burn about 20 to 30 minutes each

Three little candles in a row (sea salt, black pepper and smoked paprika) make a tasting flight that's more fun than one big candle. Use them for place settings, or line them up down the middle of a long table.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt
- 1 teaspoon black peppercorns (3 g), coarsely cracked and sifted
- 1 teaspoon smoked sweet paprika
- 3 primed food-safe wicks, cut to 3 in (7.5 cm)

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the fine sea salt until smooth. Divide it among three small bowls (about 75 g each).
2. Leave the first bowl plain and fold in the flaky salt. Fold the pepper into the second bowl and beat the smoked paprika into the third until evenly colored.
3. Pack each butter into a 3 to 4 oz (90 to 120 ml) paper espresso cup or silicone votive mold in two additions, pressing firmly and tapping each cup on the counter.
4. Push a chopstick down the center of each to within ½ in (12 mm) of the bottom, twist it out and slide in a wick. Pinch the butter closed around it.
5. Chill for 1 hour, until firm all the way through.
6. Peel away the cups and set the candles in a row on a heatproof board. Trim each wick to ¼ in (6 mm), light, and give them 5 to 10 minutes to form a pool before dipping.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Mini candles melt faster than standard ones. Light them just as guests sit down, and keep spare wicks primed in case one needs relighting.

PAIR

A basket of mixed breads: baguette, rye and seeded sourdough.

SERVE

Label each one with a small card and let guests vote for a favorite.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 2

Herb Garden Candles

Fresh herbs make the prettiest candles in the book: flecks of green suspended in gold. They also make the most fragrant ones, because the gentle heat of the pool releases their oils as you dip. Two rules matter here. First, dry your herbs completely after washing: even a few drops of water will make butter weep. Second, use the Clean-Burn Core so leaves never touch the wick.

RECIPES 16–30

RECIPE 016

V GF NF

Rosemary & Sea Salt Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

If one candle could stand for this whole book, it would be this one: golden butter, piney rosemary and a crunch of sea salt, glowing inside a crusty loaf. It is elegant enough for Christmas dinner and easy enough for a Tuesday.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons very finely chopped fresh rosemary (from about 3 sprigs), patted completely dry
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated (optional)
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt, plus more to finish
- 1 small rosemary sprig, to decorate
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. Strip the rosemary leaves from the stems and chop them as finely as you can; large needles are tough to eat. Beat the butter with the chopped rosemary, garlic (if using) and fine salt until evenly speckled. Fold in the flaky salt.
2. Before packing, press the small rosemary sprig flat against the inside wall of the cup so it shows on the outside of the finished candle.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Rosemary is strong. If you're unsure, start with 1½ tablespoons, taste the butter and add more. The sprig on the outside is decoration only; keep it well away from the flame.

PAIR

Crusty sourdough, rosemary focaccia (Bread B2), or the No-Knead Crusty Bread Bowl (Bread B1).

SERVE

Set the candle in the center of a hollowed sourdough loaf, tear the bread around it into chunks, and finish with a few flakes of salt as the pool forms.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 017

V GF NF

Maître d'Hôtel Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Maître d'hôtel butter, with parsley, lemon and a pinch of pepper, is the classic French butter served on steaks and fish. As a candle it's fresh, green and bright, and it goes with absolutely everything.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons finely chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley, patted completely dry
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- 1 teaspoon fresh lemon juice
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- ¼ teaspoon finely ground white or black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt and pepper until creamy. Add the lemon juice a few drops at a time, beating well after each addition. Fold in the parsley and lemon zest until evenly distributed.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP The lemon juice is the only liquid, so add it slowly. If the butter looks curdled, chill it for 5 minutes and beat again until smooth.

PAIR

Baguette, crusty dinner rolls, or boiled baby potatoes.

SERVE

Serve with grilled fish, steak or roast chicken, and let guests spoon the melted butter over their plates.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 018

V GF NF

Fines Herbes Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Fines herbes is the delicate French blend of parsley, chives, tarragon and chervil. Together they taste like a spring garden. This candle is soft-spoken and lovely with eggs, fish and good bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- 2 teaspoons finely chopped fresh tarragon
- 2 teaspoons finely chopped fresh chervil (or extra parsley)
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Make sure all the herbs are completely dry, then chop them together on a board until fine. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy, then fold in the herbs.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Chop the herbs with a very sharp knife rather than a food processor, which bruises them and turns them dark.

PAIR

Brioche, sourdough, or thin rye crispbreads.

SERVE

Perfect for brunch beside soft-boiled eggs, asparagus spears and smoked trout.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 019

V GF NF

Herbes de Provence & Lavender Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Dried thyme, savory, rosemary and a whisper of lavender carry you straight to a sunny terrace in the south of France. Because the herbs are dried, this candle keeps for weeks, so make two and keep one in the freezer.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons herbes de Provence (5 g), crumbled between your fingers
- ¼ teaspoon dried culinary lavender buds, finely crushed (optional)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 teaspoon honey
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Crumble the herbes de Provence and lavender together between your fingers to release their oils. Beat the butter with the salt and honey until smooth, then beat in the herbs.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Lavender turns soapy if you use too much. Use only culinary lavender, and if your herbes de Provence blend already contains it, leave the extra out.

PAIR

Fougasse, baguette, or olive bread.

SERVE

Serve with a Provençal board: olives, tapenade, cherry tomatoes and goat cheese, with a chilled rosé.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 020

V GF NF

Thyme & Lemon Zest Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Fresh thyme and lemon are a quietly perfect pair: earthy, bright and fragrant. This is one of the most versatile candles in the book; it suits chicken, fish, vegetables and every kind of bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons fresh thyme leaves, patted dry
- Finely grated zest of 1 large lemon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Strip the thyme leaves from their stems by running your fingers down each sprig. Chop them lightly. Beat the butter with the salt and pepper until creamy, then fold in the thyme and lemon zest.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Lemon thyme, if you can find it, makes this candle even more fragrant. Use it in place of regular thyme in the same amount.

PAIR

Sourdough, focaccia, or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Wonderful at the center of a Sunday roast chicken dinner, or with grilled vegetables in summer.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 021

V GF NF

Dill & Chive Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Dill and chives taste of Scandinavian summers. This candle is fresh, grassy and gently oniony, and it is spectacular with dark rye bread and smoked salmon.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh dill
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Dry the herbs well, then chop the dill finely and slice the chives into tiny rounds. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy, then fold in the herbs and lemon zest.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Dill wilts quickly. Chop it just before you mix it in, and use it the same day you buy it for the brightest green color.

PAIR

Dark rye, pumpernickel, or boiled new potatoes.

SERVE

Serve with a Nordic platter of smoked salmon, cucumber, pickled onions and hard-boiled eggs.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 022

V GF

Basil Pesto Swirl Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Ribbons of green pesto marbled through golden butter look stunning when you unmold this candle. Every dip tastes of basil, garlic, Parmesan and pine nuts. Homemade or good store-bought pesto both work.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons thick basil pesto, well drained of excess oil
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Spread the pesto on a paper towel for a minute to blot away any pooled oil. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy.
2. Dot the pesto over the butter and fold it through just 3 or 4 times with a spatula, so it forms swirls rather than blending in completely.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Don't overmix: the beauty of this candle is the marbling. When you pack it, place spoonfuls side by side rather than smearing, so the swirls survive.

PAIR

Ciabatta, focaccia, or grissini.

SERVE

Serve with an Italian antipasti board: mozzarella, cherry tomatoes, salami and marinated artichokes.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 023

V GF NF

Crispy Sage & Brown Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sage leaves fried in butter until they turn crisp and translucent are one of autumn's great pleasures. Here the sage and the nutty brown butter they cook in are both folded into the candle, with a few whole leaves pressed on the outside.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, divided
- 12 fresh sage leaves, patted completely dry
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. Cut ½ cup (113 g) of the butter into cubes and leave it to soften to 65°F (18°C).
2. Melt the remaining ½ cup (113 g) in a small skillet over medium heat. Add the sage leaves and fry for 1 to 2 minutes, until crisp and the butter is turning golden brown. Lift out the leaves and drain on a paper towel. Pour the brown butter into a bowl and let it cool, then chill for 20 to 30 minutes, stirring often, until opaque and soft-set.
3. Choose 3 of the prettiest leaves for decoration and crumble the rest finely.
4. Beat the brown butter, softened butter, crumbled sage and salt together until smooth. Before packing, press the 3 whole leaves flat against the inside wall of the cup.
5. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
6. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
7. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Make sure the sage is completely dry before frying, or it will spatter. The fried leaves stay crisp for about an hour, so fry them just before you start.

PAIR

Sourdough, pumpkin bread, or roasted butternut squash.

SERVE

A natural centerpiece for Thanksgiving or any autumn supper, with a dish of roasted squash and a pile of warm rolls.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 024

V GF NF

Tarragon Béarnaise Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Béarnaise, the famous steak sauce, gets its flavor from tarragon, shallot and a tangy vinegar reduction. All three go into this candle, which tastes uncannily like the sauce, only far easier to make.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons white wine vinegar
- 1 small shallot, very finely minced (about 1 tablespoon)
- ½ teaspoon black peppercorns, crushed
- 1½ tablespoons finely chopped fresh tarragon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a small saucepan, simmer the vinegar, shallot and peppercorns over medium-low heat until only about 1 teaspoon of liquid remains, 3 to 4 minutes. Spread on a plate and cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Beat in the cooled shallot reduction, then fold in the tarragon.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Reducing the vinegar concentrates its flavor without adding liquid. Make sure it is completely cool before it touches the butter.

PAIR

Crusty baguette, or skin-on French fries for dipping.

SERVE

Set it beside a platter of sliced steak and fries for a steak-frites night at home.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 025

V GF NF

Cilantro-Lime Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Zingy, fresh and a little spicy, this candle loves anything grilled. Try it with warm tortillas or corn on the cob, and let the melted butter run all over.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons finely chopped fresh cilantro, patted completely dry
- Finely grated zest of 2 limes
- ½ small jalapeño, seeded and very finely minced (optional)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Fold in the cilantro, lime zest and jalapeño (if using) until evenly distributed.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Chop the cilantro leaves and the thin upper stems; they're full of flavor. Skip the thick lower stems, which are watery.

PAIR

Warm flour or corn tortillas, cornbread, or grilled corn.

SERVE

Serve at a taco night or summer barbecue, with grilled corn, lime wedges and crumbled cotija.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 026

V GF NF

Chimichurri Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Argentina's beloved herb sauce is fresh, garlicky, tangy and a little spicy. Folding it into butter turns it into a candle that's perfect beside anything from the grill.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- ½ teaspoon red pepper flakes
- 1 teaspoon red wine vinegar
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, mash the garlic, oregano, red pepper flakes and salt with the vinegar to make a paste. Add the butter and beat until smooth, then fold in the parsley.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP The red pepper flakes can scorch if they touch the flame, which is one more reason to use the Clean-Burn Core here.

PAIR

Grilled bread, ciabatta, or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Serve at an asado-style barbecue with grilled steak, sausages and roasted peppers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 027

V GF NF

Chervil & Chive Spring Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Chervil tastes like a gentle mix of parsley and anise. With chives and a little lemon, it makes a delicate, pale-green candle that feels like the first warm day of spring.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh chervil
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- A few edible flowers (such as violas or chive blossoms), to decorate (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy, then fold in the chervil, chives and lemon zest.
2. If using edible flowers, press them flat against the inside wall of the cup before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Edible flowers should be pesticide-free and sold for eating. Keep them on the sides of the candle, never on top near the flame.

PAIR

Brioche, sourdough, or radishes and sugar snap peas.

SERVE

Lovely for Easter or a spring brunch with asparagus, soft cheeses and smoked trout.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 028

V GF NF

Bay Leaf & Juniper Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 30 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bay and juniper are the scent of a winter kitchen: piney, resinous and warming. The herbs are steeped in ghee, then strained away, leaving a clear, golden candle that burns beautifully and tastes of the forest.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (210 g) ghee or clarified butter
- 4 fresh or dried bay leaves, torn
- 1 teaspoon juniper berries, lightly crushed
- 3 strips orange peel (no white pith)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 small whole bay leaf, to decorate
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the ghee with the torn bay leaves, juniper and orange peel in a small saucepan over very low heat for 15 minutes; it should barely bubble. Remove from the heat and steep for 15 minutes more.
2. Strain through a fine sieve into a pouring jug, pressing on the aromatics. Let the ghee cool, stirring now and then.
3. Press the whole bay leaf flat against the inside wall of the mold.
4. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
6. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Strained and poured, this is the cleanest-burning candle in the chapter. Ghee is grainy at room temperature, so serve this candle straight from the fridge.

PAIR

Dark rye, chestnut bread, or roasted root vegetables.

SERVE

Beautiful at a winter supper beside roast pork, game or roasted beets.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 029

V GF NF

Greek Oregano & Lemon Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Greek oregano is sun-dried on the hillsides and tastes stronger and sweeter than ordinary oregano. With lemon and garlic, it makes a candle that tastes like a seaside taverna.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons dried Greek oregano, crumbled
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the oregano, lemon zest, garlic, salt and pepper until evenly blended.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Rub the oregano between your palms over the bowl as you add it; the friction releases its aromatic oils.

PAIR

Warm pita, village bread, or grilled halloumi.

SERVE

Serve with a Greek mezze spread: olives, feta, tomatoes, cucumber and grilled lamb or chicken skewers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 030

V GF NF

Three-Herb Garden Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Three bands of color (parsley green, golden thyme and pale chive) stacked one on top of another. It's the showpiece of the chapter and much easier than it looks.

INGREDIENTS

For the base

1½ cups (3 sticks / 340 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)

1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)

For the layers

2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley

1 tablespoon fresh thyme leaves, chopped, plus finely grated zest of ½ lemon

1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives

1 primed food-safe wick

2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Divide it equally among three bowls (about 115 g each). Fold the parsley into the first bowl, the thyme and lemon zest into the second, and the chives into the third.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 16 oz (475 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the parsley butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Pack the thyme butter on top, smooth, and chill for 15 minutes. Finish with the chive layer, smooth the top and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The short chills between layers keep the lines crisp. Pack each new layer gently at first, so you don't press it into the soft layer beneath.

PAIR

A basket of mixed sourdough, rye and baguette.

SERVE

Unmold it in front of your guests: the reveal of the three layers is half the fun.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 3

Garlic, Onion & Roasted Candles

Garlic butter is the reason many people fall in love with edible candles in the first place. This chapter goes far beyond it: sweet roasted garlic, inky black garlic, jammy caramelized onions, sun-dried tomatoes and wild mushrooms. Because these candles contain fresh alliums, they always use the Clean-Burn Core, and they must always be kept in the fridge until you light them.

RECIPES 31–44

RECIPE 031

V GF NF

Roasted Garlic Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 45 minutes roasting • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Roasting turns sharp garlic into something soft, sweet and spreadable, almost like caramel. A whole head goes into this candle, and it's mellow enough that even garlic skeptics keep coming back for more.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 whole head garlic
- 1 teaspoon olive oil
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F (200°C). Slice the top ¼ in (6 mm) off the garlic head to expose the cloves, drizzle with the oil and wrap tightly in foil. Roast for 40 to 45 minutes, until the cloves are deep golden and completely soft. Cool completely.
2. Squeeze the cloves out of their skins into a bowl and mash them to a smooth paste with a fork. You should have about 2 tablespoons.
3. Add the butter and salt and beat until smooth, then fold in the parsley.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** The garlic must be completely cool, or it will melt the butter. Roast it the day before and keep it in the fridge to save time.

PAIR

Baguette, ciabatta, or the Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath (Bread B3) for the ultimate garlic lover.

SERVE

Serve with an Italian dinner, or simply with a basket of warm bread and a bowl of olives.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 032

V GF NF

Black Garlic Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Black garlic is garlic that has been slowly aged until the cloves turn soft, sweet and jet black, with flavors of balsamic, molasses and tamarind. Beaten into butter, it makes a dramatic, deep-gray candle with an unforgettable taste.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 6 to 8 black garlic cloves (about 25 g), peeled
- ½ teaspoon balsamic vinegar
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the black garlic cloves with the balsamic vinegar and salt to a smooth paste using a fork or mortar and pestle.
2. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until the color is an even, smoky taupe.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Black garlic is sold peeled or in whole heads at specialty stores and many supermarkets. It's soft and sticky, so mash it thoroughly; lumps are fine to eat but look less elegant.

PAIR

Sourdough, dark rye, or toasted brioche.

SERVE

Serve on a black slate or dark ceramic plate for drama, with a steak dinner or a mushroom risotto.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 033

V GF NF

Garlic Confit & Parsley Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 40 minutes cooking • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Garlic confit means garlic cloves cooked slowly in oil until they're tender and golden. They taste softer and rounder than roasted garlic, and the cloves are left in little pieces, so every dip finds one.

INGREDIENTS

- 12 large garlic cloves, peeled
- ½ cup (120 ml) olive oil
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Put the garlic cloves and oil in a small saucepan; the oil should cover the garlic. Cook over the lowest possible heat for 35 to 40 minutes, until the cloves are pale gold and soft enough to crush with a spoon. Lift the cloves out, drain on paper towels and cool completely.
2. Chop the garlic cloves roughly. Beat the butter with the salt, then fold in the garlic and parsley.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Refrigerate leftover garlic oil in a sealed jar and use it within 4 days; garlic in oil should never be kept at room temperature.

PAIR

Baguette, grilled sourdough, or crostini.

SERVE

Serve with a summer tomato salad, grilled vegetables or a big bowl of pasta.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 034

V GF NF

Caramelized Onion Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 40 minutes cooking • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Onions cooked low and slow until they turn deep brown and jammy are pure comfort. Folded into butter with a little thyme, they make a sweet, savory candle that tastes like the best part of French onion soup.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tablespoon butter, for cooking
- 1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced
- ½ teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- 1 teaspoon balsamic vinegar
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the 1 tablespoon butter in a skillet over medium-low heat. Add the onion and a pinch of salt and cook, stirring every few minutes, for 35 to 40 minutes, until soft and deep golden brown. Add the thyme and balsamic and cook for 1 minute more, until the pan is dry.
2. Cool the onions completely, then chop them finely. You should have about 3 tablespoons.
3. Beat the softened butter with the salt until creamy, then fold in the onions.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The onions must be completely dry and cool. If they still look moist, spread them on a paper towel for a few minutes before chopping.

PAIR

Rye bread, pretzel rolls, or toasted baguette.

SERVE

A cozy winter candle for a soup-and-bread supper, or alongside burgers and grilled sausages.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 035

V GF NF

French Onion Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 40 minutes cooking • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Everything that makes French onion soup irresistible (sweet onions, nutty Gruyère, a little thyme and a splash of sherry) in a candle. Serve it with toasted baguette for the full effect.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tablespoon butter, for cooking
- 1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced
- 1 tablespoon dry sherry or brandy (optional)
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ⅓ cup (30 g) finely grated Gruyère
- ½ teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the 1 tablespoon butter in a skillet over medium-low heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring every few minutes, for 35 to 40 minutes, until deep golden. Add the sherry (if using) and cook until the pan is completely dry. Cool completely, then chop finely.
2. Beat the softened butter with the salt until creamy. Fold in the onions, Gruyère and thyme.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Grate the Gruyère on the finest holes of the grater so it disappears into the butter. Larger shreds clump and can make the candle crumble.

PAIR

Thick slices of toasted baguette, rubbed with a cut garlic clove.

SERVE

Serve in winter with a green salad and a glass of red wine, or beside a pot of soup.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 036

V GF NF

Shallot & Red Wine Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Known in France as beurre marchand de vin, this is the butter traditionally melted over steak. Shallots and red wine are reduced to a glossy syrup, giving the candle a pretty blush color and a deep, savory flavor.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tablespoon butter, for cooking
- 2 shallots, very finely minced
- ¾ cup (180 ml) dry red wine
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. Melt the 1 tablespoon butter in a small saucepan over medium heat. Add the shallots and cook for 3 minutes, until soft. Add the wine and simmer until it has reduced to about 1 tablespoon of syrupy liquid, 10 to 12 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Beat the softened butter with the salt and pepper until creamy. Beat in the shallot reduction until evenly colored, then fold in the parsley.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Reduce the wine until it is truly syrupy. Any extra liquid will bead on the surface of the candle.

PAIR

Baguette, sourdough, or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Set it next to a sliced steak, or serve it at a wine-tasting evening with a cheese board.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 037

V GF NF

Sour Cream & Onion Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

It tastes like the potato chip flavor you grew up with, made grown-up. Buttermilk powder gives the tang of sour cream without the water, and plenty of chives make it look fresh and green.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon buttermilk powder (8 g)
- 1 teaspoon onion powder
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder
- 2 tablespoons finely sliced fresh chives
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Whisk the buttermilk powder, onion powder, garlic powder and salt together in a medium bowl. Add the butter and beat until completely smooth. Fold in the chives.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Buttermilk powder is sold in the baking aisle. It adds tang without moisture, which is exactly what a candle needs.

PAIR

Kettle-cooked potato chips, soft rolls, or crispy roasted potato wedges.

SERVE

Perfect for game day or a casual party with crudités, potato skins and chips.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 038

V GF NF

Roasted Red Pepper & Garlic Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Roasted red peppers give this candle a soft coral color and a sweet, smoky flavor. A little roasted garlic and smoked paprika round it out. It's gorgeous on a summer table.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 jarred roasted red pepper (about 50 g), drained
- 4 roasted garlic cloves (see Roasted Garlic Butter Candle, recipe 31), or 1 small raw clove, grated
- ½ teaspoon smoked sweet paprika
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Pat the pepper very dry with paper towels, pressing out as much liquid as you can. Chop it finely, then blot it again.
2. Mash the garlic with the paprika and salt. Add the butter and beat until smooth, then fold in the pepper.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Drying the pepper well is the key to this candle. Press it between paper towels twice: it should leave almost no moisture behind.

PAIR

Ciabatta, grilled flatbread, or Manchego and crackers.

SERVE

Serve on a summer tapas board with olives, Manchego, almonds and slices of chorizo.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 039

V GF NF

Sun-Dried Tomato & Garlic Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sun-dried tomatoes are intensely sweet and savory, and they give this candle a warm brick-red color. Basil and a little garlic make it taste like a summer pizza.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons oil-packed sun-dried tomatoes (about 30 g), drained, blotted and very finely chopped
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh basil, patted dry
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Blot the sun-dried tomatoes on paper towels to remove as much oil as possible, then chop them very finely.
2. Beat the butter with the garlic and salt until creamy. Fold in the sun-dried tomatoes and basil.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP For an even deeper red color, blitz 1 tablespoon of the tomatoes with the butter in a food processor, then fold in the rest by hand for texture.

PAIR

Focaccia, ciabatta, or breadsticks.

SERVE

Serve with an Italian antipasti board or alongside a big bowl of pasta.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 040

V GF NF

Wild Mushroom & Thyme Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Dried porcini give this candle its deep, woodsy flavor, and a few sautéed mushrooms add texture. It's earthy, savory and perfect for autumn evenings.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tablespoon (5 g) dried porcini mushrooms
- 1 tablespoon butter, for cooking
- 3 oz (85 g) cremini or chestnut mushrooms, very finely chopped
- 1 teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the dried porcini to a fine powder in a spice grinder.
2. Melt the 1 tablespoon butter in a skillet over medium-high heat. Add the chopped mushrooms and cook, stirring, for 6 to 8 minutes, until all their liquid has evaporated and they are golden and dry. Stir in the thyme. Cool completely.
3. Beat the softened butter with the porcini powder and salt until evenly colored, then fold in the cooked mushrooms.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Cook the mushrooms until they are completely dry and beginning to brown. Any moisture left in them will make the candle weep.

PAIR

Sourdough, walnut bread, or toasted brioche.

SERVE

Serve with a mushroom risotto, a roast chicken or an autumn cheese board.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 041

V GF NF

Spring Onion & Ginger Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Scallions and fresh ginger are a classic Chinese pairing, usually served with poached chicken. In butter they make a fresh, zingy candle that is wonderful with steamed buns and dumplings.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 scallions (spring onions), green and white parts, very finely sliced
- 2 teaspoons finely grated fresh ginger
- ½ teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Squeeze the grated ginger in your fist over the sink to remove excess juice. Dry the scallions well with a paper towel.
2. Beat the butter with the ginger, sesame oil and salt until creamy, then fold in the scallions.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Fresh ginger is very juicy. Squeezing out the juice keeps all the flavor in the pulp and stops the butter from weeping.

PAIR

Steamed bao buns, scallion pancakes, or milk bread.

SERVE

Serve with dumplings, steamed greens and a bowl of jasmine rice.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 042

V GF NF

Garlic Bread Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

All the flavor of a hot loaf of garlic bread, in a candle. Garlic, parsley and Parmesan melt into a pool that turns any bread into the best garlic bread you've ever had.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 garlic cloves, finely grated
- ⅓ cup (30 g) finely grated Parmesan
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- ¼ teaspoon red pepper flakes (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the garlic, salt and red pepper flakes (if using) until creamy. Fold in the Parmesan and parsley.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Parmesan is traditionally made with animal rennet. For a strictly vegetarian candle, choose a vegetarian hard cheese.

PAIR

Baguette, Italian bread, or the Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath (Bread B3).

SERVE

Serve with a big bowl of spaghetti, a lasagna or a pizza night spread.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 043

V GF NF

Roasted Shallot & Balsamic Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 30 minutes roasting • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Whole shallots roasted until they collapse into sweet, sticky softness, with a little balsamic for tang. This candle is sophisticated and gently sweet, wonderful on a cheese board.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 shallots, peeled and halved
- 1 teaspoon olive oil
- 1 teaspoon balsamic vinegar
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F (200°C). Toss the shallots with the oil on a small baking tray and roast for 25 to 30 minutes, turning once, until soft and caramelized. Drizzle with the balsamic and return to the oven for 2 minutes. Cool completely, then chop finely.
2. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Fold in the shallots and thyme.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Choose a thick, aged balsamic if you have one. Thin balsamic adds liquid; reduce it in a small pan by half first.

PAIR

Walnut bread, crackers, or sourdough.

SERVE

Serve on a cheese board with aged cheddar, blue cheese, grapes and walnuts.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 044

V GF NF

Triple Allium Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 45 minutes, plus roasting • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Three layers, three members of the onion family: sweet caramelized onion at the base, roasted garlic in the middle, and fresh green chive on top. It's a garlic lover's dream and a showstopper on any table.

INGREDIENTS

For the base

1½ cups (3 sticks / 340 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)

1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)

For the layers

2 tablespoons cooled, finely chopped caramelized onions (see recipe 34)

4 roasted garlic cloves, mashed (see recipe 31)

2 tablespoons finely sliced fresh chives

1 primed food-safe wick

2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Divide it equally among three bowls (about 115 g each). Fold the caramelized onions into the first bowl, the roasted garlic into the second, and the chives into the third.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 16 oz (475 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the onion butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Pack the garlic butter on top, smooth and chill for 15 minutes. Finish with the chive layer, smooth the top and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Make the caramelized onions and roasted garlic a day ahead, so all you have to do on the day is mix and pack.

PAIR

A basket of baguette, rye and soft pretzel rolls.

SERVE

The perfect centerpiece for a dinner party; slice into it from the side so every guest gets all three layers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 4

Cheese Candles

Cheese doesn't burn, so a "cheese candle" is really a butter candle with cheese folded through it. As the pool melts, the cheese softens into the butter, and every dip tastes like the best cheese toast you've ever eaten. The rule that makes these work: hard cheeses grated on the finest holes of the grater (no more than ½ cup / 45 g per candle), soft cheeses crumbled small and chilled (no more than 2 oz / 56 g), and always the Clean-Burn Core.

RECIPES 45–60

A NOTE ON VEGETARIAN CHEESE Many traditional hard cheeses, including Parmesan, Pecorino Romano, Gruyère and Manchego, are made with animal rennet. Recipes are marked vegetarian on the assumption that you'll choose a vegetarian version where needed; most supermarkets carry them.

RECIPE 045

V GF NF

Cacio e Pepe Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Rome's famous pasta, made with nothing but Pecorino, black pepper and pasta water, is all about the perfect balance of salty cheese and spicy pepper. This candle captures it exactly.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated Pecorino Romano
- 2 teaspoons black peppercorns (6 g), toasted and coarsely cracked
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Toast the peppercorns in a dry skillet over medium heat for 1 minute, until fragrant. Cool, crack them coarsely and sift away the dust.
2. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Fold in the Pecorino and cracked pepper.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pecorino is very salty; taste the butter before adding the salt and leave it out if the cheese is strong enough.

PAIR

Crusty Italian bread, grissini, or warm focaccia.

SERVE

Serve with a platter of Italian cured meats, or alongside a bowl of pasta.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 046

V GF NF

Aged White Cheddar & Chive Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sharp aged cheddar and fresh chives are a crowd-pleasing classic. As the pool melts, the cheddar softens into the butter, so the bread comes out tasting like the best grilled cheese.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated extra-sharp white cheddar
- 2 tablespoons finely sliced fresh chives
- ¼ teaspoon mustard powder
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the mustard powder and salt until creamy. Fold in the cheddar and chives.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Mustard powder sharpens the cheddar flavor without adding moisture. It's the secret ingredient in every great cheese sauce.

PAIR

Soft pretzels, sourdough, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve on a ploughman's board with ham, pickles, apples and crusty bread.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 047

V GF

Gorgonzola, Honey & Walnut Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Creamy blue cheese, sweet honey and toasted walnuts: the classic cheese-board trio, now in one candle. It's rich and bold, made for a glass of port or a sweet dessert wine.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 oz (56 g) Gorgonzola dolce or other creamy blue cheese, chilled and crumbled small
- 2 tablespoons walnuts (15 g), toasted and very finely chopped
- 2 teaspoons honey
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the honey and salt until smooth. Gently fold in the crumbled Gorgonzola and walnuts, leaving little marbled pockets of cheese.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Crumble the cheese while it's cold from the fridge, and fold it in at the very end. Overmixing turns the whole candle blue-gray.

PAIR

Walnut bread, raisin bread, or pear slices.

SERVE

Serve at the end of a meal with pears, figs, grapes and a glass of port.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 048

V GF NF

Goat Cheese & Herb Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Tangy fresh goat cheese and soft green herbs make a bright, creamy candle that tastes like springtime. It's a gentle introduction to cheese candles.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 oz (56 g) fresh goat cheese, chilled and crumbled
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt and lemon zest until creamy. Fold in the herbs, then gently fold in the goat cheese, leaving small pockets.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Fresh goat cheese is soft, so keep it in the fridge until the moment you crumble it. Cold cheese stays in neat pieces.

PAIR

Baguette, crackers, or sliced cucumber and radishes.

SERVE

Serve with a spring salad, roasted beets or a bowl of marinated olives.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 049

V GF NF

Gruyère & Thyme Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Gruyère is nutty, savory and melts like a dream. With fresh thyme and a touch of garlic, it makes a candle that tastes like the top of a croque monsieur.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated Gruyère
- 1 teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ½ small garlic clove, finely grated
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- Pinch of freshly grated nutmeg
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the garlic, salt and nutmeg until creamy. Fold in the Gruyère and thyme.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Swiss Gruyère, aged at least 12 months, has the deepest flavor. Comté is an excellent substitute.

PAIR

Toasted baguette, rye bread, or ham and pickles.

SERVE

Serve with a winter salad of bitter greens and apples, or alongside a bowl of soup.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 050

V GF NF

Smoked Gouda & Paprika Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Smoked Gouda has a creamy texture and a mellow, bacon-like smokiness that people love. Smoked paprika gives the candle a warm color and doubles down on the flavor.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated smoked Gouda
- 1 teaspoon smoked sweet paprika
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the paprika, garlic powder and salt until evenly colored. Fold in the Gouda.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Smoked Gouda is softer than Parmesan, so chill it in the freezer for 15 minutes before grating. It'll grate finely instead of smearing.

PAIR

Pretzel bites (Bread B6), cornbread, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve on game day or at a barbecue with sausages, pickles and mustard.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 051

V GF NF

Pimento Cheese Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

A Southern classic. Sharp cheddar, sweet pimentos and a little heat make this candle bright orange, cheerful and very hard to stop eating.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated extra-sharp orange cheddar
- 2 tablespoons jarred pimentos, drained, patted very dry and finely chopped
- ¼ teaspoon smoked paprika
- Pinch of cayenne pepper
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Press the pimentos between paper towels until they're as dry as possible.
2. Beat the butter with the paprika, cayenne and salt until creamy. Fold in the cheddar and pimentos.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The pimentos carry the most moisture here. Press them twice; it makes all the difference to how well the candle holds.

PAIR

Saltine crackers, celery sticks, or soft white rolls.

SERVE

Serve with Southern-style snacks: deviled eggs, pickled okra, crackers and celery.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 052

V GF NF

Manchego & Quince Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

In Spain, nutty Manchego is always served with membrillo, a sweet, firm quince paste. Here tiny cubes of quince are folded through Manchego butter, like jewels.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated aged Manchego
- 1 oz (28 g) quince paste (membrillo), cut into ¼ in (6 mm) cubes
- ¼ teaspoon smoked paprika
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Chill the quince cubes in the freezer for 10 minutes so they stay neat.
2. Beat the butter with the paprika and salt until creamy. Fold in the Manchego, then the quince cubes.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Quince paste is firm and doesn't weep, which makes it ideal for candles. Fig jam and other preserves are too wet.

PAIR

Crusty Spanish bread, almonds, or picos (Spanish breadsticks).

SERVE

Serve on a tapas spread with Marcona almonds, olives, jamón and a glass of sherry.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 053

V GF NF

Feta, Oregano & Lemon Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Salty, tangy feta with oregano and lemon is pure Greek sunshine. It's a lighter-tasting cheese candle, ideal for summer.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 oz (56 g) feta, chilled, patted dry and finely crumbled
- 1 teaspoon dried Greek oregano
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the oregano, lemon zest and pepper until creamy. Gently fold in the feta.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Feta is stored in brine. Pat it dry and let it sit on a paper towel for 10 minutes before crumbling. Don't add salt; the feta brings plenty.

PAIR

Warm pita, sesame bread rings, or cucumber slices.

SERVE

Serve with a Greek salad, grilled vegetables and lamb skewers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 054

V GF NF

Pecorino, Lemon & Mint Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Salty Pecorino, fresh mint and bright lemon are a classic Roman spring trio, usually tossed with fava beans. In a candle they're fresh, unusual and delicious.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ⅓ cup (30 g) very finely grated Pecorino Romano
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh mint, patted dry
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the lemon zest and pepper until creamy. Fold in the Pecorino and mint.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Chop the mint just before adding it, or it will darken. Spearmint works best; peppermint is too strong.

PAIR

Grilled bread, fava beans, or fresh peas.

SERVE

Serve in spring with fresh fava beans, peas in their pods and young Pecorino to snack on.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 055

V GF NF

Jalapeño Popper Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Everyone's favorite party snack, in candle form: spicy jalapeños, sharp cheddar and a little cream cheese tang. Serve it at your next game-day gathering and watch it vanish.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ⅓ cup (30 g) very finely grated sharp cheddar
- 1 oz (28 g) cream cheese, softened
- 2 tablespoons pickled jalapeños, patted very dry and finely chopped
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the cream cheese with the garlic powder and salt until smooth. Add the butter and beat until combined.
2. Fold in the cheddar and jalapeños.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use pickled rather than fresh jalapeños; they have a better tang and an even heat. Pat them dry twice.

PAIR

Tortilla chips, cornbread, or soft pretzels.

SERVE

Serve with wings, nachos and a cold beer on game day.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 056

V GF NF

Brie & Fig Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Brie and figs are a marriage made in heaven. Small pieces of creamy Brie and chewy dried figs are folded through the butter, with a hint of honey and thyme.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 oz (56 g) Brie, rind removed, chilled and cut into ¼ in (6 mm) cubes
- 3 dried figs (about 30 g), stems removed, finely chopped
- 1 teaspoon honey
- ½ teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Freeze the Brie cubes for 15 minutes so they hold their shape.
2. Beat the butter with the honey, thyme and salt until smooth. Fold in the figs, then the cold Brie cubes.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Removing the Brie rind keeps the candle smooth. Save the rind for snacking.

PAIR

Baguette, walnut bread, or crisp apple slices.

SERVE

A beautiful holiday candle served with fresh figs, grapes and a glass of Champagne.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 057

V GF NF

Alpine Fondue Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Gruyère, Emmental, a hint of garlic, a touch of nutmeg and a splash of kirsch: everything that goes into a classic Swiss fondue. Dip in cubes of bread and enjoy fondue night without the pot.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated Gruyère
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated Emmental
- ½ small garlic clove, finely grated
- 1 teaspoon kirsch or dry white wine (optional)
- Pinch of freshly grated nutmeg
- Pinch of white pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the garlic, kirsch (if using), nutmeg and white pepper until creamy. Fold in both cheeses.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP A teaspoon of kirsch is enough to flavor the butter without making it wet. Beat it in thoroughly before the cheese goes in.

PAIR

Cubes of crusty bread, boiled baby potatoes, and cornichons.

SERVE

Serve with fondue forks, cubed bread, boiled potatoes, pickles and apple slices for a cozy winter evening.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 058

V NF

Pub Cheddar & Ale Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Inspired by Welsh rarebit, the cheese-on-toast of British pubs: sharp cheddar, a reduction of ale, mustard and a dash of Worcestershire. It's rich and savory, made for a pint.

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup (120 ml) ale or stout
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (45 g) very finely grated extra-sharp cheddar
- 1 teaspoon English mustard or Dijon mustard
- ½ teaspoon Worcestershire sauce (use a vegetarian brand if needed)
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Simmer the ale in a small saucepan until reduced to about 1 tablespoon of syrup, 6 to 8 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the ale syrup, mustard, Worcestershire and salt until smooth. Fold in the cheddar.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Beer contains gluten. For a gluten-free candle, use a gluten-free beer and a gluten-free Worcestershire sauce.

PAIR

Pretzel bites (Bread B6), Quick Beer Bread (Bread B4), or rye toast.

SERVE

Serve at a pub-style evening with sausages, pickled onions and a pint.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 059

V GF NF

Pizza Night Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Mozzarella, Parmesan, tomato and oregano: this candle tastes exactly like a slice of pizza. Kids love it, and so do the adults.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated low-moisture mozzarella
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated Parmesan
- 1 tablespoon sun-dried tomatoes in oil, blotted dry and very finely chopped
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder
- Pinch of red pepper flakes (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the oregano, garlic powder and red pepper flakes until creamy. Fold in both cheeses and the sun-dried tomatoes.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use low-moisture mozzarella (the firm block, not fresh balls in water). Fresh mozzarella is far too wet for a candle.

PAIR

Pizza dough knots, breadsticks, or focaccia.

SERVE

Serve on family pizza night with a big salad and breadsticks.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 060

V GF NF

Three-Cheese Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

A tower of three cheeses: sharp white cheddar at the base, nutty Gruyère in the middle and salty Parmesan with black pepper on top. It's the centerpiece of any cheese lover's party.

INGREDIENTS

For the base

- 1½ cups (3 sticks / 340 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)

For the layers

- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated white cheddar, plus 1 tablespoon sliced chives
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated Gruyère, plus ½ teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ¼ cup (22 g) very finely grated Parmesan, plus ½ teaspoon cracked black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Divide it equally among three bowls (about 115 g each). Fold the cheddar and chives into the first bowl, the Gruyère and thyme into the second, and the Parmesan and pepper into the third.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 16 oz (475 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the cheddar butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Pack the Gruyère butter on top, smooth and chill for 15 minutes. Finish with the Parmesan layer, smooth the top and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Label your bowls before you start; the three cheese butters look very similar until they're layered.

PAIR

A basket of baguette, rye and sourdough, plus crisp apple slices.

SERVE

Set it on a cake stand surrounded by wedges of the three cheeses, grapes and crackers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 5

Around-the-World Candles

Nearly every food culture has a way of flavoring fat: North African spice pastes, Indian tempered ghee, Korean chili paste, Ethiopian spiced butter. This chapter takes those flavors and turns them into candles. Many are bolder and spicier than the rest of the book, so set them out with plenty of bread and a cooling dip, and let your guests travel the world from the table.

RECIPES 61–76

RECIPE 061

V GF

Za'atar & Lemon Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Za'atar is a Middle Eastern blend of wild thyme, tangy sumac and toasted sesame. With lemon zest and good butter, it makes a fragrant, earthy candle that's perfect with warm flatbread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons za'atar (12 g), divided
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with 1½ tablespoons of the za'atar, the lemon zest and the salt until evenly speckled.
2. Scatter the remaining ½ tablespoon za'atar inside the empty mold and roll it around before packing, so it coats the outside of the candle.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Za'atar blends vary; some are heavy on salt. Taste yours first and reduce the salt if needed. Za'atar contains sesame.

PAIR

Warm pita, manakish, or Turkish pide bread.

SERVE

Serve with a mezze spread: hummus, labneh, olives, cucumbers and tomatoes.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 062

V GF NF

Harissa Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Harissa, the North African chili paste, brings smoky heat, garlic and warm spice. This candle is a gorgeous brick-red color, and it's bold and spicy, so a little goes a long way.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons harissa paste (30 g)
- ½ teaspoon ground cumin, toasted
- 1 teaspoon honey
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh cilantro, patted dry
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, mix the harissa, cumin, honey and salt. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until evenly red. Fold in the cilantro.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Harissa heat varies widely between brands. Start with 1 tablespoon, taste, then add more. Rose harissa is a little sweeter and more floral.

PAIR

Warm flatbread, couscous, or roasted carrots.

SERVE

Serve with roasted vegetables, grilled lamb or chicken, and a bowl of cool yogurt.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 063

V GF NF

Ras el Hanout & Honey Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Ras el hanout means "head of the shop" in Arabic: the spice merchant's best blend. Warm with cinnamon, cumin, ginger and rose, it pairs beautifully with honey in this sweet-and-savory candle.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons ras el hanout (5 g)
- 2 teaspoons honey
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the ras el hanout and salt until evenly colored. Beat in the honey a little at a time until smooth.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Warm the ras el hanout in a dry pan for 30 seconds before adding it. It wakes up the spices and gives a deeper flavor.

PAIR

Flatbread, date bread, or roasted squash.

SERVE

Serve with a Moroccan tagine, roasted vegetables, or a bowl of dates and almonds.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 064

V GF NF

Tadka Ghee Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 25 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Tadka is the Indian technique of sizzling spices in hot ghee to release their flavor. Here the spiced ghee is strained and poured into a beautiful amber candle that smells incredible as it burns.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (210 g) ghee
- 1 teaspoon cumin seeds
- 1 teaspoon black mustard seeds
- 8 fresh or dried curry leaves
- 2 dried red chilies, broken in half
- ½ teaspoon ground turmeric
- ¾ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Heat ¼ cup (50 g) of the ghee in a small saucepan over medium heat. Add the cumin and mustard seeds; when they begin to pop, after about 30 seconds, add the curry leaves and chilies and sizzle for 15 seconds more.
2. Remove from the heat, stir in the turmeric, then add the remaining ghee and stir until melted. Steep for 10 minutes.
3. Strain into a pouring jug, pressing on the spices. Let the ghee cool, stirring now and then.
4. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
6. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

FIRST-TRY TIP Have everything measured before you start; tadka moves fast and spices burn in seconds. If you like, save the strained spices and scatter them over rice.

PAIR

Warm naan, roti, or paratha.

SERVE

Serve with dal, rice and pickles, or with a platter of samosas and pakoras.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 065

V GF NF

Yuzu Kosho Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Yuzu kosho is a Japanese paste of fragrant yuzu citrus peel, green chili and salt. It's bright, floral and spicy, and a tiny amount transforms butter. This is one of the most surprising candles in the book.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ teaspoons green yuzu kosho
- Finely grated zest of ½ lime
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced chives
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the yuzu kosho with the lime zest and salt. Add the butter and beat until evenly pale green, then fold in the chives.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Yuzu kosho is salty and spicy; taste the butter before adding more. Find it in Japanese grocery stores or online.

PAIR

Milk bread, rice crackers, or steamed potatoes.

SERVE

Serve with grilled fish, steamed vegetables or a plate of sashimi.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 066

V NF

Gochujang Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Korean gochujang is a fermented chili paste that's spicy, sweet and deeply savory all at once. Beaten into butter, it makes a fiery red candle that's impossible to stop dipping into.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons gochujang (35 g)
- 1 teaspoon honey
- ½ teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds
- 1 scallion, green part only, finely sliced
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mix the gochujang, honey and sesame oil until smooth. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until evenly red. Fold in the sesame seeds and scallion.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Most gochujang contains wheat. Look for a gluten-free brand if you need to. Gochujang is salty, so no extra salt is needed.

PAIR

Milk bread, scallion pancakes, or steamed buns.

SERVE

Serve with Korean fried chicken, kimchi and steamed rice, or with a platter of grilled meats.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 067

V GF NF

Lemongrass, Lime Leaf & Chili Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

The bright, aromatic flavors of Thailand: citrusy lemongrass, perfumed lime leaves, fresh chili and a touch of coconut sugar. It's fresh, zingy and warming.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 stalk lemongrass, tough outer layers removed, inner core very finely minced (about 1 tablespoon)
- 3 makrut lime leaves, center rib removed, very finely shredded
- ½ red bird's-eye chili, seeded and very finely minced
- 1 teaspoon coconut sugar or light brown sugar
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a mortar and pestle, pound the lemongrass, lime leaves, chili, sugar and salt to a rough paste. (Or chop everything together very finely on a board.)
2. Add the paste to the butter and beat until evenly distributed.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Use only the tender, pale inner core of the lemongrass; the outer layers are woody and stay tough no matter how finely you chop them.

PAIR

Roti, sticky rice balls, or shrimp crackers.

SERVE

Serve with grilled shrimp or chicken skewers, sticky rice and a fresh herb salad.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 068

V GF NF

Chili-Lime Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Inspired by the Mexican chili-lime seasoning sprinkled on fruit and corn, this candle is tangy, salty and gently spicy. It's sunshine in a candle.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ teaspoons ancho chili powder
- ½ teaspoon ground cumin
- Finely grated zest of 2 limes
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the chili powder, cumin, lime zest and salt until evenly colored.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Store-bought chili-lime seasoning works too: use 1 tablespoon and leave out the salt and cumin.

PAIR

Warm corn tortillas, tortilla chips, or grilled corn on the cob.

SERVE

Serve with tacos, grilled corn, mango slices and a pitcher of margaritas.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 069

V GF NF

Cajun Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bold, spicy and full of Louisiana flavor: paprika, garlic, onion, thyme and cayenne. This candle is made for a seafood boil or a basket of crusty bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons smoked paprika
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon onion powder
- ½ teaspoon dried thyme, finely crumbled
- ¼ to ½ teaspoon cayenne pepper
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Mix all the spices and the salt in a small bowl. Add to the butter and beat until evenly colored.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Crumble the dried thyme to a powder between your fingers; whole leaves can scorch near the wick in the Direct Wick method.

PAIR

French bread, cornbread, or boiled potatoes and corn.

SERVE

Set it in the middle of a seafood boil spread with shrimp, corn, potatoes and sausage.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 070

V GF NF

Jerk Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Jamaican jerk seasoning combines allspice, thyme, scotch bonnet heat and warm spices. This candle is bold, fragrant and fiery, perfect for summer cookouts.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon ground allspice
- ½ teaspoon dried thyme, crumbled
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ½ scotch bonnet or habanero chili, seeded and very finely minced (or ¼ teaspoon cayenne)
- 1 scallion, finely sliced
- 1 teaspoon brown sugar
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mix the spices, sugar and salt. Add to the butter and beat until evenly colored. Fold in the chili and scallion.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Wear gloves when handling scotch bonnet, and wash the board and knife straight away; the heat lingers.

PAIR

Coco bread, cornbread, or grilled plantains.

SERVE

Serve with jerk chicken, rice and peas, and grilled pineapple.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 071

V GF NF

Calabrian Chili & Honey Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Calabrian chilies from southern Italy are fruity, smoky and spicy. Paired with honey, they make a sweet-hot candle that's irresistible with cheese and charcuterie.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon crushed Calabrian chilies in oil, drained and blotted
- 1 tablespoon honey
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- Finely grated zest of ½ orange
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the honey, salt and orange zest until smooth. Fold in the chilies.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Blot the chilies well on paper towels; the oil they're packed in is delicious but can make the butter separate.

PAIR

Focaccia, ciabatta, or fresh ricotta on crostini.

SERVE

Serve on a charcuterie board with salami, aged cheeses, olives and fresh figs.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 072

V

Smoky Romesco Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Romesco is a Catalan sauce of roasted peppers, toasted almonds, garlic and smoked paprika. In a candle it's nutty, smoky and a lovely sunset orange.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 jarred roasted red pepper (about 50 g), patted very dry
- 2 tablespoons blanched almonds (15 g), toasted
- 1 small garlic clove
- 1 teaspoon smoked sweet paprika
- ½ teaspoon sherry vinegar
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. In a mini food processor, blitz the pepper, almonds, garlic, paprika, vinegar and salt to a thick paste. Spread the paste on paper towels for a few minutes to absorb any moisture.
2. Add the paste to the butter and beat until evenly colored.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The almonds thicken the paste and help absorb the pepper's moisture. Use a gluten-free bread on the side if needed; the candle itself is gluten-free.

PAIR

Grilled bread, toasted ciabatta, or grilled spring onions.

SERVE

Serve with grilled vegetables, grilled fish or a Spanish tapas spread.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 073

V GF NF

Berbere Spiced Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 30 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Niter kibbeh is Ethiopia's spiced clarified butter, infused with aromatics like cardamom, fenugreek and ginger. Here it's combined with berbere, the warm, complex chili blend, for a deep red candle with layers of flavor.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (210 g) ghee
- 1 tablespoon berbere spice blend
- ½ teaspoon ground fenugreek
- 4 green cardamom pods, cracked
- 1 teaspoon grated fresh ginger
- 1 small garlic clove, sliced
- ¾ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the ghee with the cardamom, ginger and garlic in a small saucepan over very low heat for 15 minutes, without letting it brown.
2. Remove from the heat, stir in the berbere and fenugreek, and steep for 10 minutes.
3. Strain through a fine sieve lined with a paper towel into a pouring jug. Let the ghee cool, stirring now and then.
4. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
6. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

FIRST-TRY TIP Straining through a paper towel removes the fine spice particles, so the candle burns cleanly while keeping all the flavor.

PAIR

Injera, flatbread, or crusty bread.

SERVE

Serve with Ethiopian lentil stews, collard greens or roasted vegetables.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 074

V GF NF

Five-Spice & Scallion Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Chinese five-spice (star anise, cloves, cinnamon, Sichuan pepper and fennel) is warm, sweet and gently numbing. With scallions and a touch of soy, it's a savory, aromatic candle.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon Chinese five-spice powder
- 1 teaspoon soy sauce or tamari
- ½ teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 2 scallions, finely sliced
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mix the five-spice, soy sauce, sesame oil and salt. Add to the butter and beat until smooth. Fold in the scallions.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use tamari instead of soy sauce for a gluten-free candle.

PAIR

Scallion pancakes, bao buns, or prawn crackers.

SERVE

Serve with roast duck, char siu pork or crispy tofu, and a plate of steamed greens.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 075

GF NF

Café de Paris Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Café de Paris butter was invented in a Geneva restaurant in the 1930s and is still served there on steak today. Its exact recipe is a secret, but most versions use more than a dozen herbs, spices and seasonings. This is my version: complex, savory and utterly delicious.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
- 1 teaspoon ketchup
- 1 anchovy fillet, mashed to a paste
- 1 teaspoon capers, rinsed, dried and finely chopped
- 1 teaspoon finely minced shallot
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped mixed fresh herbs (parsley, tarragon, chives)
- ½ teaspoon mild curry powder
- ¼ teaspoon sweet paprika
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, mash the mustard, ketchup, anchovy, capers, shallot, curry powder, paprika, lemon zest and salt together to a paste.
2. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until smooth. Fold in the herbs.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Don't skip the anchovy. You won't taste fish; it simply makes everything more savory.

PAIR

Fries, baguette, or grilled sourdough.

SERVE

Serve with sliced steak and fries for a special steak-frites night.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 076

V GF

Sumac & Pistachio Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Tangy, lemony sumac and sweet pistachios give this candle a beautiful color contrast of deep red and green. A drizzle of pomegranate molasses adds a sweet-sour finish.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons ground sumac
- 2 tablespoons shelled pistachios (15 g), toasted and very finely chopped, divided
- 1 teaspoon pomegranate molasses
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the sumac, pomegranate molasses and salt until evenly blended. Fold in 1½ tablespoons of the pistachios.
2. Scatter the remaining pistachios inside the empty mold before packing so they decorate the outside of the candle.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Pomegranate molasses is very concentrated; 1 teaspoon is all you need. Beat it in thoroughly.

PAIR

Warm pita, sesame bread, or barbari bread.

SERVE

Serve with a Middle Eastern spread: labneh, fattoush salad, grilled kebabs and fresh pomegranate seeds.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 6

Smoky, Bacon & Tallow Candles

This is the savory heart of the book: bacon, cured meats, beef tallow and duck fat. Tallow and duck fat are old-fashioned cooking fats that also happen to burn beautifully, and they make some of the firmest, most reliable candles of all. Meat-based candles are the most perishable in the book: cook every meat until crisp, keep the candles in the fridge until the last minute, and enjoy them within 2 hours of setting them out.

RECIPES 77–86

RECIPE 077

GF NF

Bacon Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Crispy bacon and a spoonful of its rendered fat folded into butter: this is the candle that makes people's eyes widen. It's smoky, salty and wildly popular at every party.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 slices smoked bacon (about 115 g)
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Cook the bacon in a skillet over medium heat until very crisp, 8 to 10 minutes. Drain on paper towels and pour 1 tablespoon of the rendered fat into a small bowl. Cool both completely.
2. Chop the bacon very finely; you should have about ¼ cup (30 g).
3. Beat the butter with the cooled bacon fat and pepper until smooth. Fold in the bacon and chives.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The bacon must be completely crisp: chewy bacon holds moisture and fat that can make the candle soft. Bacon is salty, so no extra salt is needed.

PAIR

Cornbread, buttermilk biscuits, or sourdough.

SERVE

Serve at brunch with eggs and pancakes, or at a barbecue with cornbread and grilled corn.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 078

GF NF

Maple Bacon Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sweet maple and smoky bacon, the ultimate brunch combination. The bacon is glazed with maple syrup before it's chopped, so it's sweet, salty and crunchy.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 slices smoked bacon (about 115 g)
- 1 tablespoon pure maple syrup, plus 1 tablespoon for the butter
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- Pinch of cayenne pepper (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F (200°C) and line a baking sheet with parchment. Lay out the bacon, bake for 12 minutes, then brush with 1 tablespoon maple syrup and bake for 4 to 6 minutes more, until crisp and lacquered. Cool completely on the parchment, then chop finely.
2. Beat the butter with the remaining 1 tablespoon maple syrup, salt and cayenne (if using) until smooth. Fold in the bacon.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Glazed bacon crisps up as it cools. Watch it closely in the last few minutes; maple syrup burns quickly.

PAIR

Pancakes, waffles, buttermilk biscuits, or cornbread.

SERVE

Serve at brunch surrounded by stacks of pancakes, waffles, fruit and coffee.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 079

GF NF DF

Rosemary Beef Tallow Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 25 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Beef tallow was used to make candles long before paraffin existed, and it's still one of the best edible candle fats. It burns cleanly, sets rock-solid and tastes richly savory. Infused with rosemary and garlic, it's my favorite candle for steak night.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (210 g) beef tallow
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 2 garlic cloves, lightly crushed
- 1 teaspoon black peppercorns, lightly crushed
- 1 teaspoon flaky sea salt, plus more to finish
- 1 small rosemary sprig, to decorate
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the tallow with the rosemary, garlic and peppercorns in a small saucepan over very low heat for 15 minutes, until fragrant. Do not let the garlic brown.
2. Strain into a pouring jug and let cool, stirring now and then.
3. Press the small rosemary sprig against the inside wall of the mold. Pour the candle as below, and sprinkle the flaky salt over the top once it has set but before you light it.
4. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Tallow sets quickly once it cools. If it gets too thick to pour, warm it gently for a few seconds. Choose grass-fed beef tallow for the cleanest flavor.

PAIR

Crusty sourdough, Yorkshire puddings, or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Serve beside a carved roast beef or sliced steak, and dip bread into the savory tallow pool.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 080

GF NF DF

Texas Tallow & Black Pepper Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 20 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Texas barbecue is all about salt, coarse black pepper and smoke. This tallow candle captures that simple, powerful flavor, and it tastes like the bark on a perfect brisket.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (210 g) beef tallow
- 1 tablespoon coarsely ground black pepper
- 1 teaspoon smoked sea salt
- ½ teaspoon garlic powder
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Melt the tallow in a small saucepan over low heat. Stir in the garlic powder and steep for 5 minutes.
2. Strain through a fine sieve into a pouring jug and let it cool, stirring now and then.
3. Just after pouring, when the tallow is beginning to set but is still soft, sprinkle the pepper and smoked salt over the top, keeping them away from the wick.
4. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pepper sinks in liquid tallow, which is why it goes on top at the end, as a crust, rather than in the pour.

PAIR

White sandwich bread, cornbread, or pickles and onions on the side.

SERVE

Serve at a barbecue with sliced brisket, pickles, onions and white bread, Texas-style.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 081

GF NF

'Nduja Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

'Nduja is a soft, spicy, spreadable salami from Calabria. It melts into butter beautifully, giving a fiery orange candle with a deep, porky richness.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons (30 g) 'nduja, at room temperature
- 1 teaspoon honey
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the 'nduja with the honey and lemon zest until smooth. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until evenly orange.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP 'Nduja is already salty and spicy, so no other seasoning is needed. Look for it in Italian delis, sold in jars or as a soft sausage.

PAIR

Focaccia, ciabatta, or grilled sourdough.

SERVE

Serve on an Italian board with burrata, olives and grilled vegetables.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 082

GF NF

Chorizo & Smoked Paprika Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Spanish chorizo, cooked until crispy, gives this candle a smoky, garlicky depth and a beautiful red-orange color from its paprika-rich fat.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 oz (56 g) dry-cured Spanish chorizo, finely diced
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ teaspoon smoked sweet paprika
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Cook the chorizo in a dry skillet over medium heat for 5 to 6 minutes, until crisp and the oil has run out. Drain on paper towels, reserving 1 teaspoon of the red oil. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the reserved chorizo oil and paprika until evenly colored. Fold in the crisp chorizo and parsley.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use dry-cured Spanish chorizo, not fresh Mexican chorizo, which is raw and crumbly.

PAIR

Crusty bread, pan con tomate, or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Serve with Spanish tapas: patatas bravas, olives, Manchego and garlic shrimp.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 083

GF NF

Pancetta & Black Pepper Carbonara Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

The flavors of a Roman carbonara (crispy pancetta, Pecorino and lots of black pepper) in a candle. Rich, salty and peppery, it's hearty comfort.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 oz (56 g) pancetta, finely diced
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ⅓ cup (30 g) very finely grated Pecorino Romano
- 1½ teaspoons black peppercorns, coarsely cracked and sifted
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Cook the pancetta in a dry skillet over medium heat for 6 to 8 minutes, until crisp and golden. Drain on paper towels and cool completely, then chop finely.
2. Beat the butter with the pepper until creamy. Fold in the Pecorino and pancetta.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pancetta and Pecorino are both salty, so taste before you add any salt (you probably won't need it).

PAIR

Crusty Italian bread, focaccia, or breadsticks.

SERVE

Serve with an Italian dinner, or simply with a green salad and a glass of white wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 084

GF NF DF

Duck Fat & Thyme Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 20 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Duck fat is prized by chefs for its silky texture and rich, savory flavor. It makes a smooth, golden candle that's heavenly with crusty bread or roasted potatoes.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (160 g) duck fat
- 1¾ oz (50 g) food-grade cocoa butter, chopped
- 4 sprigs fresh thyme
- 1 garlic clove, lightly crushed
- ¾ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the duck fat, cocoa butter, thyme and garlic in a small saucepan over very low heat for 15 minutes, until the cocoa butter has melted and the fat is fragrant.
2. Strain into a pouring jug and let cool, stirring now and then.
3. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
5. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

FIRST-TRY TIP Duck fat alone is too soft to hold a candle shape. The deodorized cocoa butter firms it without changing the flavor.

PAIR

Crusty French bread, or crispy roast potatoes for dipping.

SERVE

Serve with roast duck or chicken, or alongside a bowl of crispy roasted potatoes.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 085

V GF NF

Chipotle Adobo Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Chipotle chilies in adobo sauce are smoked jalapeños in a tangy, tomatoey sauce. A little goes a long way, giving this candle a deep, smoky heat and a rich rust color.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 chipotle chili in adobo, very finely chopped, plus 1 teaspoon adobo sauce
- Finely grated zest of 1 lime
- ½ teaspoon ground cumin
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the chipotle, adobo sauce, lime zest, cumin and salt into a paste. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition, until evenly colored.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Freeze leftover chipotles in adobo in an ice cube tray. Each cube is the right amount for another candle.

PAIR

Cornbread, warm tortillas, or grilled sweet potato wedges.

SERVE

Serve with barbecued meats, grilled corn and black bean salad.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 086

GF NF

Roasted Bone Marrow & Parsley Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes, plus 20 minutes roasting • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Roasted bone marrow is one of the great luxuries of the restaurant world: rich, savory and meltingly soft. Folded into butter with parsley and shallot, it makes a candle that's indulgent and unforgettable.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 beef marrow bones, about 3 in (7.5 cm) long, cut lengthwise by your butcher
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley, patted dry
- 1 teaspoon very finely minced shallot
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

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METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 450°F (230°C). Roast the marrow bones cut-side up on a baking sheet for 15 to 20 minutes, until the marrow is soft and just beginning to bubble. Scoop out the marrow (you'll need about 2 tablespoons) and cool completely, then chill for 15 minutes.
2. Mash the cold marrow with the salt and shallot. Add the butter and beat until smooth, then fold in the parsley and lemon zest.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Ask your butcher to cut the bones lengthwise ("canoe cut"); it makes scooping out the marrow much easier.

PAIR

Toasted sourdough, grilled bread, or crostini.

SERVE

Serve with a parsley and shallot salad on the side, steakhouse-style, with a glass of red wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 3 days in the fridge or 1 month in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 7

Sweet Butter Candles

Sweet edible candles are a delightful surprise at brunch, at afternoon tea or as dessert. Think of them as warm, melting sweet butter to dip brioche, waffles, fruit and cookies into. Two techniques make them work: powdered sugar instead of granulated (so the candle is silky, never gritty), and freeze-dried fruit ground to a powder (so you get bright fruit flavor and color with no water at all). Sugar caramelizes quickly near a flame, so every sweet candle uses the Clean-Burn Core.

RECIPES 87–102

RECIPE 087

V GF NF

Honey & Sea Salt Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Golden honey and flaky salt are a perfect pair: sweet, salty and simple. This is the sweet candle to start with, and the one that pleases everybody.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons honey (40 g), at room temperature
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the fine salt until creamy. Add the honey a teaspoon at a time, beating well after each addition, until light and smooth. Fold in the flaky salt.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Use a thick, set or creamed honey if you can; it blends in more evenly and keeps the candle firmer than runny honey.

PAIR

Warm biscuits, cornbread, brioche, or toasted English muffins.

SERVE

Serve at breakfast with warm biscuits, or with a cheese board of aged cheddar and apples.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 088

V GF NF

Cinnamon Toast Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Everybody's childhood favorite: buttery cinnamon toast. This candle smells like a cozy kitchen as it melts, and it's especially good with thick slices of toasted brioche.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons powdered sugar (24 g)
- 2 teaspoons ground cinnamon, plus 1 teaspoon mixed with 1 teaspoon superfine sugar for coating
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, 2 teaspoons cinnamon, vanilla and salt until light and evenly colored.
2. Sprinkle the cinnamon-sugar mixture inside the empty mold and roll it around to coat the sides before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Ceylon cinnamon is sweeter and more delicate than the more common cassia; either works, but taste and adjust.

PAIR

Toasted brioche, challah, or French toast sticks.

SERVE

Serve at a weekend brunch with fresh fruit and coffee, or as an after-school treat with toast soldiers.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 089

V GF

Maple Pecan Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Real maple syrup and toasted pecans make this candle taste like the best stack of pancakes. It's warm, nutty and sweet, perfect for autumn brunches.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup, at room temperature
- 1 tablespoon powdered sugar (8 g)
- 3 tablespoons pecans (20 g), toasted and very finely chopped, divided
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, cinnamon and salt until creamy. Add the maple syrup a teaspoon at a time, beating well after each addition. Fold in 2 tablespoons of the pecans.
2. Scatter the remaining pecans inside the empty mold before packing to decorate the outside of the candle.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Use pure maple syrup, not pancake syrup, which is mostly corn syrup and will make the candle weep.

PAIR

Pancakes, waffles, cornbread, or pumpkin bread.

SERVE

Serve with stacks of pancakes or waffles, crispy bacon and a jug of extra maple syrup.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 090

V GF NF

Bourbon Brown Sugar Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bourbon, brown sugar and vanilla: warm, caramel-like and a little grown-up. The bourbon is reduced first, so you get all of its flavor with none of its sharpness.

INGREDIENTS

- ¼ cup (60 ml) bourbon
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons light brown sugar (36 g), finely sifted
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Simmer the bourbon in a small saucepan over low heat until reduced to about 1 tablespoon, 3 to 4 minutes. Keep the pan away from open flames. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the brown sugar, vanilla and salt until light and creamy, about 2 minutes. Beat in the bourbon reduction.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Brown sugar can be lumpy; push it through a sieve before adding it. Beat for a full 2 minutes so the sugar dissolves into the butter.

PAIR

Cornbread, sweet potato biscuits, or grilled peaches.

SERVE

Serve for dessert with grilled peaches and vanilla ice cream, or at brunch with cornbread.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 091

V GF NF

Vanilla Bean Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Simple, pure and elegant: sweet butter flecked with real vanilla seeds. It's the sweet equivalent of the Classic Sea Salt candle, and it goes with everything from strawberries to scones.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 vanilla bean, split and seeds scraped (or 1 teaspoon vanilla bean paste)
- 3 tablespoons powdered sugar (24 g)
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the vanilla seeds, powdered sugar and salt until light, creamy and evenly speckled, about 2 minutes.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Don't throw away the scraped vanilla pod; push it into a jar of sugar to make vanilla sugar.

PAIR

Scones, brioche, strawberries, or shortbread.

SERVE

Serve at afternoon tea with scones, strawberries and clotted cream.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 092

V GF NF

Lemon Sugar Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bright and sunny, this candle tastes like lemon drizzle cake. Rubbing lemon zest into the sugar releases its oils, so the flavor is intensely fresh.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons powdered sugar (24 g)
- Finely grated zest of 2 lemons
- 1 teaspoon fresh lemon juice
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Rub the lemon zest into the powdered sugar with your fingertips until fragrant and slightly damp.
2. Beat the butter with the lemon sugar and salt until light and creamy. Beat in the lemon juice a few drops at a time.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP For a pretty finish, add a pinch of freeze-dried raspberry powder to a third of the butter and swirl it through before packing.

PAIR

Pound cake, scones, blueberry muffins, or shortbread.

SERVE

Serve at a spring tea party or a baby shower with blueberries, scones and lemon cake.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 093

V GF NF

Strawberry Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Freeze-dried strawberries, ground to a powder, give this candle a pretty pink color and an intense summer-fruit flavor, with no water to make it weep.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (about 10 g) freeze-dried strawberries
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ¼ teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the freeze-dried strawberries to a fine powder in a food processor or spice grinder. Sift to remove the seeds.
2. Beat the butter with the strawberry powder, powdered sugar, vanilla and salt until light and evenly pink.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Freeze-dried fruit absorbs moisture from the air. Grind it just before using, and keep the bag sealed.

PAIR

Scones, croissants, waffles, or sweet rolls.

SERVE

Serve at brunch with fresh strawberries, croissants and a pot of tea.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 094

V GF NF

Raspberry & Rose Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Raspberry and rose is a classic French pairing: fruity, floral and a little romantic. This candle is a gorgeous deep pink, perfect for an anniversary or a bridal shower.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (about 10 g) freeze-dried raspberries
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ½ teaspoon rose water
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 teaspoon dried edible rose petals, to decorate (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the freeze-dried raspberries to a fine powder and sift out the seeds.
2. Beat the butter with the raspberry powder, powdered sugar and salt until light and pink. Beat in the rose water a few drops at a time.
3. If using, press the rose petals against the inside wall of the mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Rose water varies a lot in strength. Start with ¼ teaspoon, taste, and add more slowly; too much tastes like soap.

PAIR

Brioche, madeleines, or shortbread cookies.

SERVE

Serve at a bridal shower or Valentine's tea with macarons, raspberries and Champagne.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 095

V GF NF

Blueberry Lemon Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Blueberry and lemon are one of the happiest flavor pairings there is. This candle is a lovely lavender-blue color and tastes like a warm blueberry muffin.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (about 10 g) freeze-dried blueberries
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the freeze-dried blueberries to a fine powder.
2. Beat the butter with the blueberry powder, powdered sugar, lemon zest and salt until light and evenly colored.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Freeze-dried blueberries can be a little chewy to grind. Let the processor run for a full minute, then sift.

PAIR

Muffins, pancakes, scones, or lemon pound cake.

SERVE

Serve at brunch with blueberry pancakes and fresh berries.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 096

V GF NF

Orange Blossom & Honey Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Orange blossom water is the delicate, floral flavor used in Middle Eastern and Mediterranean pastries. With honey and orange zest, it makes a fragrant, sunny candle.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons honey
- Finely grated zest of 1 orange
- ½ teaspoon orange blossom water
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the orange zest and salt until creamy. Beat in the honey a teaspoon at a time, then the orange blossom water, a few drops at a time.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP As with rose water, orange blossom water is strong. Add it slowly, tasting as you go.

PAIR

Brioche, semolina cake, or warm flatbread.

SERVE

Serve with Middle Eastern pastries, dates, figs and a pot of mint tea.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 097

V GF NF

Cardamom & Brown Sugar Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

In Scandinavia, cardamom is the spice of choice for sweet buns and pastries. With brown sugar, it makes a warm, aromatic candle that's perfect for a cozy fika coffee break.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons light brown sugar (36 g), finely sifted
- 1 teaspoon freshly ground cardamom (from about 12 green pods)
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the brown sugar, cardamom, cinnamon and salt for 2 minutes, until light and creamy.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Freshly ground cardamom is far more fragrant than pre-ground. Crack the pods, remove the black seeds and grind them in a mortar and pestle.

PAIR

Cardamom buns, rye crispbread, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve with a pot of coffee and cardamom buns for a Swedish fika.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 098

V GF NF

Apple Pie Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Freeze-dried apple, cinnamon, nutmeg and brown sugar give this candle the flavor of a warm apple pie. Serve it with pie-crust "dippers" for extra fun.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (about 10 g) freeze-dried apple slices
- 2 tablespoons light brown sugar (24 g), finely sifted
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the freeze-dried apple to a fine powder.
2. Beat the butter with the apple powder, brown sugar, spices and salt until light and evenly colored.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP For pie-crust dippers, cut store-bought pie dough into strips, brush with milk, sprinkle with cinnamon sugar and bake at 400°F (200°C) for 10 to 12 minutes.

PAIR

Pie-crust dippers, cinnamon raisin bread, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve at an autumn party with apple slices, cheddar cheese and warm cider.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 099

V NF

Speculoos Spice Cookie Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Speculoos are the crisp, spiced Belgian cookies often served with coffee. Their warm spices of cinnamon, ginger, nutmeg and clove make a candle that tastes like a cookie dipped in butter.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons speculoos cookie spread (cookie butter)
- 1 tablespoon powdered sugar (8 g)
- 1 teaspoon speculoos spice mix, or ½ teaspoon cinnamon plus a pinch each of ginger, nutmeg and cloves
- 2 speculoos cookies, finely crushed, for coating
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the cookie spread, powdered sugar and spices until light and smooth.
2. Scatter the crushed cookies inside the empty mold and roll them around to coat the sides before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP The cookie crumbs on the outside add crunch; keep them only on the outside, never near the wick.

PAIR

Speculoos cookies, waffles, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve with coffee at the end of a dinner party, with cookies and apple slices for dipping.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 100

V GF

Toasted Coconut & Lime Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Toasted coconut and lime are pure tropical holiday. This candle is light, sweet and zesty, lovely with grilled pineapple or banana bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons unsweetened shredded coconut (15 g), toasted, divided
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- Finely grated zest of 2 limes
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Toast the coconut in a dry skillet over medium-low heat, stirring constantly, for 3 to 4 minutes, until golden. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, lime zest and salt until light. Fold in 2 tablespoons of the coconut. Scatter the rest inside the empty mold before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Coconut burns quickly. Stir it constantly and pour it onto a plate the moment it turns golden.

PAIR

Banana bread, grilled pineapple, or Hawaiian sweet rolls.

SERVE

Serve at a summer party with grilled pineapple, mango and coconut cookies.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 101

V GF

Banana Bread Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Freeze-dried banana, brown sugar, cinnamon and toasted walnuts make a candle that tastes just like a warm slice of banana bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ cup (about 10 g) freeze-dried banana slices
- 2 tablespoons light brown sugar (24 g), finely sifted
- ½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 2 tablespoons walnuts (15 g), toasted and very finely chopped
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the freeze-dried banana to a fine powder.
2. Beat the butter with the banana powder, brown sugar, cinnamon and salt until light. Fold in the walnuts.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP For a nut-free candle, swap the walnuts for 1 tablespoon of toasted oats.

PAIR

Banana bread, toasted brioche, or waffles.

SERVE

Serve at brunch with banana bread, sliced bananas and a pot of coffee.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 102

V GF NF

Strawberry Vanilla Blueberry Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Three pastel layers of strawberry pink, vanilla cream and blueberry lavender. It's a showstopper for birthday brunches, baby showers and summer parties.

INGREDIENTS

For the base

- 1½ cups (3 sticks / 340 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup powdered sugar (32 g)
- Pinch of fine sea salt

For the layers

- ⅓ cup (about 7 g) freeze-dried strawberries, ground and sifted
- ½ vanilla bean, seeds scraped (or ½ teaspoon vanilla bean paste)
- ⅓ cup (about 7 g) freeze-dried blueberries, ground
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar and salt until light. Divide it equally among three bowls (about 120 g each). Beat the strawberry powder into the first bowl, the vanilla seeds into the second, and the blueberry powder into the third.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 16 oz (475 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the blueberry butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Pack the vanilla butter on top, smooth and chill for 15 minutes. Finish with the strawberry layer, smooth the top and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Pack the darkest color first, at the bottom; it makes the layers look neater and brighter.

PAIR

Scones, waffles, brioche, and fresh berries.

SERVE

Set it on a cake stand surrounded by fresh berries and pastries for a celebration brunch.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 8

Chocolate Candles

Chocolate on its own won't hold a flame, but chocolate beaten into butter makes a candle that is firm, glossy and silky, and that melts into the most luxurious dip imaginable: somewhere between warm ganache and chocolate butter. Every candle in this chapter starts from the same base, and every one uses the Clean-Burn Core, so the flame only ever touches pure clarified butter and the chocolate never scorches.

RECIPES 103–116

The Chocolate Candle Base

Every recipe in this chapter uses this method. Read it once, and the rest of the chapter is easy.

1. **Melt the chocolate gently.** Chop it finely and melt it in a heatproof bowl set over a pan of barely simmering water, or in the microwave in 20-second bursts, stirring between each.
2. **Cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).** It should still be fluid but feel just cool against your lip. Warmer chocolate will melt the butter; cooler chocolate will set in streaks.
3. **Beat the butter first,** with the sugar and flavorings, until light and creamy.
4. **Beat in the chocolate in a steady stream,** with the mixer on low, then beat for 1 minute more until glossy and evenly colored.
5. **Pack it right away,** before it starts to firm up.

> CHOOSING CHOCOLATE Use good chocolate bars, not chocolate chips. Chips contain stabilizers that keep them from melting smoothly. Dark chocolate with 60 to 70% cocoa gives the best balance of richness and sweetness.

RECIPE 103

V GF NF

Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

This is the base candle for the chapter: rich, dark and silky, with a scattering of flaky salt to make the chocolate taste even deeper. It's simple, sophisticated and endlessly dippable.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C), following the Chocolate Candle Base.
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, vanilla and fine salt until light and creamy. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate in a steady stream and beat for 1 minute more, until glossy.
3. After lighting the finished candle, sprinkle the flaky salt over the top so it melts into the pool.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Check the chocolate's temperature with a thermometer. It's the single detail that decides whether this candle turns out smooth or streaky.

PAIR

Strawberries, brioche, shortbread, or pretzel rods.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with fresh strawberries, orange segments, shortbread and a glass of red wine or port.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 104

V GF

Milk Chocolate Hazelnut Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Milk chocolate and toasted hazelnuts are the flavors of the world's favorite chocolate spread. This candle is creamy, nutty and a favorite with kids and grown-ups alike.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) milk chocolate, finely chopped
- 1 tablespoon chocolate hazelnut spread
- 3 tablespoons hazelnuts (20 g), toasted, skinned and very finely chopped, divided
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the milk chocolate and cool it to 86 to 88°F (30 to 31°C); milk chocolate likes it slightly cooler than dark.
2. Beat the butter with the hazelnut spread and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate in a steady stream and beat until glossy. Fold in 2 tablespoons of the hazelnuts.
3. Scatter the remaining hazelnuts inside the empty mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** To skin toasted hazelnuts, rub them in a clean kitchen towel while they're still warm; most of the papery skins will flake off.

PAIR

Croissants, brioche, banana slices, or waffles.

SERVE

Serve at a weekend brunch with croissants and fresh fruit, or as an after-school treat.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 105

V GF NF

White Chocolate & Raspberry Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sweet, creamy white chocolate and tart raspberries make a pretty pink-flecked candle that's perfect for celebrations. Freeze-dried raspberries add color and tang with no extra moisture.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) good white chocolate, finely chopped
- ¼ cup (about 5 g) freeze-dried raspberries, lightly crushed, plus a few whole ones
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the white chocolate very gently and cool it to 84 to 86°F (29 to 30°C).
2. Beat the butter with the vanilla and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the white chocolate in a steady stream and beat until smooth. Fold in the crushed raspberries.
3. Press a few whole freeze-dried raspberries against the inside wall of the mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP White chocolate scorches easily. Melt it over barely simmering water or in 15-second microwave bursts, and stop when a few small pieces remain; stir until they melt.

PAIR

Shortbread, madeleines, strawberries, or brioche.

SERVE

Serve at a bridal shower or birthday with fresh berries, macarons and sparkling wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 106

V GF NF

Mexican Hot Chocolate Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Mexican hot chocolate is spiced with cinnamon and a whisper of chili. This candle is rich, warming and gently spicy, perfect with churros or cinnamon sugar dippers.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ancho chili powder
- Pinch of cayenne pepper
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, spices and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate in a steady stream and beat until glossy.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP The ancho chili adds warmth rather than heat. Add the cayenne pinch by pinch until you like the kick.

PAIR

Churros, cinnamon sugar tortilla chips, or sweet bread.

SERVE

Serve with churros and mugs of hot chocolate on a cold evening, or as dessert after a Mexican dinner.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 107

V GF NF

Chocolate Orange Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Dark chocolate and orange is a classic holiday combination, rich, bright and festive. Fresh orange zest gives it a lovely zing.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- Finely grated zest of 1 large orange
- ½ teaspoon orange extract or 1 teaspoon orange liqueur (optional)
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 2 strips candied orange peel, to decorate (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

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METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, orange zest, orange extract (if using) and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. If using, press the candied peel strips against the inside wall of the mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Zest the orange directly over the butter bowl to capture all the fragrant oils that spray from the peel.

PAIR

Panettone, orange slices, biscotti, or shortbread.

SERVE

Serve at Christmas with panettone, clementines and a glass of dessert wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 108

V GF NF

Mocha Espresso Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Rich dark chocolate and bold espresso make a grown-up candle for coffee lovers. It's wonderful with biscotti at the end of a dinner party.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- 2 teaspoons instant espresso powder, dissolved in ½ teaspoon hot water
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- A few chocolate-covered espresso beans, to decorate (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

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METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C). Let the espresso mixture cool.
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, espresso mixture, vanilla and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. If using, press the espresso beans into the outside of the candle once it's unmolded, keeping them low and away from the wick.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Instant espresso powder gives a strong coffee flavor without adding liquid. Brewed coffee is too wet for a candle.

PAIR

Biscotti, chocolate cookies, or brioche.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with biscotti and small cups of espresso.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 109

V GF NF

Mint Chocolate Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Cool peppermint and rich dark chocolate taste like an after-dinner mint. This candle is refreshing, indulgent and perfect for the holidays.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ½ teaspoon pure peppermint extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh mint leaves, to decorate (optional)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, peppermint extract and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Peppermint extract is very strong. Start with ¼ teaspoon, taste, and add more a drop at a time.

PAIR

Chocolate cookies, brownies, strawberries, or shortbread.

SERVE

Serve after a holiday dinner with brownie bites, strawberries and chocolate cookies.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 110

V GF

Chocolate Peanut Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Chocolate and peanut butter: possibly the most beloved candy-bar combination of all. This candle is sweet, salty, rich and perfect with pretzels.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) milk or dark chocolate, finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons smooth peanut butter
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 2 tablespoons roasted peanuts, finely chopped, for coating
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the peanut butter, powdered sugar and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. Scatter the chopped peanuts inside the empty mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use a regular commercial smooth peanut butter rather than a natural one; natural peanut butters separate and can make the candle oily.

PAIR

Pretzel rods, banana slices, apple slices, or graham crackers.

SERVE

Serve at a movie night or game day with pretzels, bananas and apple slices.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 111

V GF NF

Salted Caramel Chocolate Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Brown butter brings a toffee-like depth, and a spoonful of thick caramel ribbons through the dark chocolate. Finished with flaky salt, it's indulgent and impossible to resist.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, divided
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 1 tablespoon light brown sugar, finely sifted
- 1 tablespoon thick salted caramel sauce or dulce de leche, chilled
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

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METHOD

1. Brown ¼ cup (57 g) of the butter in a small pan until it smells nutty and the solids are golden brown. Cool, then chill until soft-set, 20 to 30 minutes. Let the remaining butter soften to 65°F (18°C).
2. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
3. Beat the brown butter, softened butter and brown sugar until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
4. Dot the chilled caramel over the chocolate butter and fold through 2 or 3 times to make ribbons. Sprinkle the flaky salt over the top of the finished candle after lighting.
5. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
6. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
7. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Use thick, cold caramel or dulce de leche; thin caramel sauce will make the candle soft. Fold it only a couple of times so it stays in ribbons.

PAIR

Pretzels, apple slices, shortbread, or brioche.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with apple slices, pretzels and vanilla ice cream.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 112

V NF

S'mores Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

All the joy of the campfire: chocolate, toasted marshmallow and graham crackers. The candle is chocolate with marshmallow cream folded in, coated in graham crumbs.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) milk chocolate, finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons marshmallow creme
- 3 graham crackers, finely crushed (about ⅓ cup / 30 g)
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 86 to 88°F (30 to 31°C).
2. Beat the butter with the marshmallow creme and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. Scatter the graham cracker crumbs inside the empty mold and roll to coat the sides before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Graham crackers contain wheat. For a gluten-free version, use gluten-free graham-style cookies.

PAIR

Graham crackers, toasted marshmallows on skewers, or strawberries.

SERVE

Serve at a backyard party or kids' sleepover with graham crackers, marshmallows on skewers and strawberries.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 113

V GF NF

Black Forest Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Inspired by the famous German cake: dark chocolate, cherries and a hint of kirsch. Freeze-dried cherries give a deep red color and intense fruity flavor.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- ¼ cup (about 5 g) freeze-dried cherries, finely crushed
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- 1 teaspoon kirsch (optional)
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, kirsch (if using) and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy. Fold in the cherries.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Freeze-dried sour cherries give the best tart flavor. Dried (not freeze-dried) cherries are too chewy and moist.

PAIR

Brioche, chocolate cake squares, or fresh cherries.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with fresh cherries, whipped cream and chocolate cake squares.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 114

V GF NF

Chocolate Chai Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Warm chai spices of cinnamon, cardamom, ginger and clove meet dark chocolate in a candle that's cozy, fragrant and a little exotic.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon ground cardamom
- ¼ teaspoon ground ginger
- Pinch each of ground cloves, black pepper and fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, spices and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Warm the spices in a dry pan for 30 seconds before adding them for a deeper aroma.

PAIR

Ginger cookies, brioche, or pear slices.

SERVE

Serve on a winter afternoon with chai lattes, ginger cookies and pear slices.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 115

V GF

Pistachio White Chocolate Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Creamy white chocolate and bright green pistachios make a beautiful, elegant candle. It's sweet, nutty and lovely for spring celebrations.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) good white chocolate, finely chopped
- 1 tablespoon pistachio cream or paste
- 3 tablespoons shelled pistachios (20 g), toasted and finely chopped, divided
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the white chocolate very gently and cool it to 84 to 86°F (29 to 30°C).
2. Beat the butter with the pistachio cream and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the white chocolate and beat until smooth. Fold in 2 tablespoons of the pistachios.
3. Scatter the remaining pistachios inside the empty mold before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pistachio cream is sold in Italian delis and online. If you can't find it, grind ¼ cup pistachios with 1 teaspoon neutral oil into a paste.

PAIR

Brioche, shortbread, or strawberries.

SERVE

Serve at Easter or a spring brunch with strawberries, shortbread and Prosecco.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 116

V GF NF

Triple Chocolate Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 50 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Three layers of chocolate: dark at the base, milk in the middle and white on top. It's dramatic, decadent and the ultimate chocolate-lover's centerpiece.

INGREDIENTS

For each layer (make three times, once with each chocolate)

- ¼ cup (½ stick / 57 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 oz (28 g) chocolate: dark (60 to 70%) for the first layer, milk for the second, white for the third
- 2 teaspoons powdered sugar
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

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METHOD

1. Make the dark chocolate layer first: melt and cool the dark chocolate to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C), beat the butter with the sugar and salt, then beat in the chocolate until glossy.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 12 oz (350 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the dark chocolate butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Make the milk chocolate layer (cooling the chocolate to 86 to 88°F / 30 to 31°C), pack it on top and chill for 15 minutes. Make the white chocolate layer (cooling to 84 to 86°F / 29 to 30°C), pack it on top, smooth and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Make each layer just before you need it; chocolate butter firms quickly and is easiest to pack while it's soft and freshly beaten.

PAIR

Strawberries, brioche, shortbread, pretzels and marshmallows.

SERVE

Set it on a cake stand surrounded by fruit and cookies for a dessert table or birthday celebration.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 9

Dairy-Free & Plant-Based Candles

Everyone deserves a candle to dip into, including guests who avoid dairy. This chapter uses three plant-based foundations, each tested to hold its shape and burn steadily:

RECIPES 117–128

- **Plant-based butter sticks.** Choose a block-style plant butter sold in sticks or bricks, ideally with at least 75% fat. Avoid tub spreads, which contain too much water and air. These are packed and wicked exactly like dairy butter.
- **Coconut-Cocoa Butter Base.** Refined coconut oil firmed with food-grade cocoa butter, melted and poured. Refined coconut oil has no coconut taste; use virgin coconut oil only if you want one.
- **Olive Oil & Cocoa Butter Base.** Extra-virgin olive oil set with an equal weight of cocoa butter. It makes a silky, Mediterranean-style candle that's wonderful with bread.

All three are softer at room temperature than dairy butter, so serve these candles straight from the fridge, light them right away, and enjoy them within 45 minutes. For the Clean-Burn Core, every recipe here uses the **Dairy-Free Core Blend**: equal weights of refined coconut oil and cocoa butter, melted together.

> MAKE IT TRULY DAIRY-FREE Check labels on plant butters, chocolate and bread: many contain milk solids, whey or butter. When hosting, serve dairy-free candles on their own board with their own bread and knives, so they stay free of dairy crumbs and drips.

RECIPE 117

V DF GF NF

Classic Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

The dairy-free equivalent of the Classic Sea Salt candle, and the place to start. A good block-style plant butter, a little flaky salt and nothing else.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g), if your plant butter is unsalted
- 1 teaspoon flaky sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Beat the plant butter (and fine salt, if using) until smooth and creamy. Fold in the flaky salt.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Plant butters soften faster than dairy butter. Work quickly, and if the butter starts to look shiny, chill the bowl for 5 minutes before packing.

PAIR

Crusty sourdough, baguette, or dairy-free focaccia.

SERVE

Serve with crudités, olives and a basket of warm bread; nobody will guess it's dairy-free.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 118

V DF GF NF

Herbed Olive Oil Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 20 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

Fine extra-virgin olive oil infused with rosemary, thyme and garlic, set firm with cocoa butter. It melts into a pool that tastes like the best bread-dipping oil you've ever had.

INGREDIENTS

- 3¾ oz (110 g) food-grade cocoa butter, chopped
- ½ cup (110 g) extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 sprig rosemary
- 2 sprigs thyme
- 1 garlic clove, lightly crushed
- ¾ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- Freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the olive oil with the rosemary, thyme and garlic in a small saucepan over very low heat for 10 minutes, without letting it sizzle. Remove from the heat and steep for 10 minutes, then strain.
2. Melt the cocoa butter in a heatproof bowl over barely simmering water. Stir in the infused oil and a few turns of pepper.
3. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
5. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use a fruity, good-quality olive oil; it's the main flavor. Weigh both fats; equal weights give the right set.

PAIR

Ciabatta, focaccia, or crusty sourdough.

SERVE

Serve with a bowl of balsamic vinegar alongside, plus olives and sun-dried tomatoes, like an Italian bread-dipping plate.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped and refrigerated, the unlit candle keeps for up to 2 weeks (freezing is not recommended). Serve straight from the fridge and enjoy within 45 minutes of lighting.

RECIPE 119

V DF GF NF

Roasted Garlic & Rosemary Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes, plus 45 minutes roasting • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sweet roasted garlic and piney rosemary in a dairy-free candle that's every bit as good as the original.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 head garlic, roasted (see Roasted Garlic Butter Candle, recipe 31, using olive oil)
- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons very finely chopped fresh rosemary
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Squeeze the cooled roasted garlic cloves into a bowl and mash to a paste.
2. Add the plant butter and salt and beat until smooth. Fold in the rosemary.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Roast the garlic a day ahead and keep it in the fridge. It must be completely cold before it goes into the plant butter.

PAIR

Sourdough, rosemary focaccia (Bread B2), or roasted potatoes.

SERVE

Serve at a dinner party alongside its dairy version so every guest has a choice.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 120

V DF GF NF

Nutritional Yeast "Parmesan" & Black Pepper Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Nutritional yeast has a nutty, savory, cheesy flavor loved by plant-based cooks. With black pepper, it makes a dairy-free take on cacio e pepe that's surprisingly convincing.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons nutritional yeast flakes (10 g)
- 1½ teaspoons black peppercorns, coarsely cracked and sifted
- ½ teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Grind the nutritional yeast to a fine powder in a spice grinder or mortar and pestle.
2. Beat the plant butter with the nutritional yeast, pepper, garlic powder and salt until smooth.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Grinding the nutritional yeast helps it dissolve into the butter for a smoother, more cheese-like texture.

PAIR

Italian bread, breadsticks, or roasted broccoli.

SERVE

Serve with a big bowl of pasta, or on a dairy-free antipasti board.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 121

V DF GF

Smoky Maple Coconut "Bacon" Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Coconut flakes tossed with smoked paprika, maple and a dash of soy, then baked until crisp, taste remarkably like bacon bits. Folded into plant butter, they make a smoky-sweet candle with crunch.

INGREDIENTS

- ⅓ cup (20 g) unsweetened large coconut flakes
- 1 teaspoon tamari or soy sauce
- 1 teaspoon pure maple syrup, plus 1 teaspoon for the butter
- ½ teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325°F (160°C). Toss the coconut flakes with the tamari, 1 teaspoon maple syrup and paprika. Spread on a parchment-lined tray and bake for 8 to 10 minutes, stirring once, until deep golden and crisp. Cool completely, then crumble finely.
2. Beat the plant butter with the remaining 1 teaspoon maple syrup and the salt until smooth. Fold in the coconut "bacon."
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Coconut flakes turn from golden to burned very quickly. Check them every 2 minutes after the first 6.

PAIR

Pancakes, cornbread, or plant-based biscuits.

SERVE

Serve at a dairy-free brunch with pancakes, fruit and coffee.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 122

V DF NF

Miso-Sesame Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

White miso and toasted sesame make plant butter taste incredibly rich and savory. This candle is so good that dairy lovers will reach for it first.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons white miso paste (36 g)
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 2 teaspoons toasted sesame seeds
- 1 scallion, green part only, finely sliced
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the miso with the sesame oil until smooth. Add the plant butter a third at a time, beating well after each addition. Fold in the sesame seeds and scallion.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Check your miso label: most are gluten-free, but some contain barley.

PAIR

Milk-free soft rolls, rice crackers, or roasted sweet potatoes.

SERVE

Serve with steamed vegetables, edamame and sweet potato wedges.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 123

V DF GF NF

Dairy-Free Dark Chocolate Sea Salt Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured with Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

A glossy dark chocolate candle made with no dairy at all: dairy-free dark chocolate, coconut oil and cocoa butter. It melts into a silky, ganache-like pool.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 oz (85 g) dairy-free dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 5 tablespoons (65 g) refined coconut oil
- 1¾ oz (50 g) food-grade cocoa butter, chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g), sifted
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt, plus flaky salt to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick (see The Food-Safe Wick Guide)
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend (equal weights refined coconut oil and food-grade cocoa butter, melted together), for the Clean-Burn Core

Continued on next page →

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate, coconut oil and cocoa butter together in a heatproof bowl set over barely simmering water, stirring until smooth. Remove from the heat and whisk in the powdered sugar, vanilla and salt until completely smooth. Let cool to 90°F (32°C), stirring now and then.
2. **Pour around a straw.** Grease a wide straw with a little Core Blend and stand it in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) paper cup or silicone mold, holding it upright with a clip across the rim. Pour the chocolate mixture around the straw to about ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 2 hours, until firm.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw. Stand a primed wick in the channel so it reaches to within ½ in (12 mm) of the bottom, and slowly fill the channel with the Core Blend, melted and cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill for 1 hour more.
4. **Light and serve.** Unmold the candle onto a heatproof plate. Trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm), light it, and sprinkle a little flaky salt over the top. Give it 10 minutes to form a pool before dipping.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Whisk the sugar in thoroughly; any lumps will sink to the bottom. If the mixture looks grainy, warm it gently and whisk again.

PAIR

Strawberries, dairy-free shortbread, or orange segments.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with fresh berries and orange segments.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped and refrigerated, the unlit candle keeps for up to 2 weeks, or in the freezer for up to 2 months. Serve straight from the fridge and enjoy within 45 minutes of lighting.

RECIPE 124

V DF GF NF

Cinnamon Maple Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Warm cinnamon and sweet maple syrup make a cozy, dairy-free candle that's perfect for pancakes, waffles and French toast.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon powdered sugar (8 g)
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the plant butter with the powdered sugar, cinnamon and salt until light. Beat in the maple syrup a teaspoon at a time.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Plant butters hold less liquid than dairy butter. Add the maple syrup slowly, and stop if the mixture starts to look curdled.

PAIR

Pancakes, waffles, or dairy-free cinnamon bread.

SERVE

Serve at a dairy-free brunch with fresh fruit and coffee.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 125

V DF GF NF

Lemon, Basil & Olive Oil Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 20 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

Bright lemon and fresh basil infused in olive oil, then set with cocoa butter. It's light, summery and perfect for an outdoor lunch, as long as it's served cold.

INGREDIENTS

- 3¾ oz (110 g) food-grade cocoa butter, chopped
- ½ cup (110 g) extra-virgin olive oil
- Peeled zest of 1 lemon, in strips (no white pith)
- 6 large basil leaves
- ¾ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Warm the olive oil with the lemon zest and basil in a small saucepan over very low heat for 5 minutes, without letting it sizzle. Remove from the heat and steep for 15 minutes, then strain.
2. Melt the cocoa butter in a heatproof bowl over barely simmering water. Stir in the infused oil.
3. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
5. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Keep the heat very low when infusing basil; if the oil gets too hot, the basil turns dark and bitter.

PAIR

Focaccia, grilled bread, or tomato bruschetta.

SERVE

Serve at a summer lunch with tomato salad, grilled vegetables and grilled bread.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped and refrigerated, the unlit candle keeps for up to 1 week (freezing is not recommended). Serve straight from the fridge and enjoy within 45 minutes of lighting.

RECIPE 126

V DF GF NF

Sun-Dried Tomato & Basil Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Sweet sun-dried tomatoes and fresh basil give this dairy-free candle a warm color and big Mediterranean flavor.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons oil-packed sun-dried tomatoes, blotted dry and very finely chopped
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh basil, patted dry
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the plant butter with the garlic and salt until creamy. Fold in the sun-dried tomatoes and basil.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Blot the tomatoes very well. Plant butter is less forgiving of extra oil than dairy butter.

PAIR

Ciabatta, focaccia, or breadsticks.

SERVE

Serve on a dairy-free Italian board with olives, marinated artichokes and grilled vegetables.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 127

V DF GF

Golden Turmeric & Ginger Coconut Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Poured • Active 20 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

Inspired by golden milk: warm turmeric, ginger, cinnamon and black pepper in a sunny yellow coconut candle. It's bright, warming and beautiful.

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup plus 2 tablespoons (130 g) refined coconut oil
- 2¼ oz (65 g) food-grade cocoa butter, chopped
- 1 teaspoon ground turmeric
- ½ teaspoon ground ginger
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of black pepper
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Melt the coconut oil and cocoa butter together in a small saucepan over low heat. Whisk in the spices and steep over the lowest heat for 5 minutes.
2. Strain through a fine sieve lined with a paper towel into a pouring jug.
3. **Pour.** Clip a primed wick upright in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold. When the fat cools to 100 to 110°F (38 to 43°C) and clouds at the edges, pour it in to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Chill for 3 hours, until firm and opaque.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.
5. **Finish with salt.** Salt doesn't dissolve in fat, so sprinkle it over the pool once lit, or serve it alongside.

FIRST-TRY TIP Straining removes the fine spice particles, so the candle burns cleanly while keeping its glowing color. Turmeric stains; use a glass or stainless-steel jug.

PAIR

Flatbread, naan, or roasted cauliflower and carrots.

SERVE

Serve with a vegetable curry or a platter of roasted spiced vegetables.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped and refrigerated, the unlit candle keeps for up to 2 weeks, or in the freezer for up to 3 months. Serve straight from the fridge and enjoy within 45 minutes of lighting.

RECIPE 128

V DF GF NF

Pumpkin Spice Plant Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Autumn in a candle: pumpkin pie spice, brown sugar and a hint of maple. Dairy-free, cozy and perfect for the holiday table.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (227 g) block-style plant-based butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons light brown sugar (24 g), finely sifted
- 1½ teaspoons pumpkin pie spice
- 1 teaspoon pure maple syrup
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) Dairy-Free Core Blend, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the plant butter with the brown sugar, pumpkin pie spice and salt for 2 minutes, until light. Beat in the maple syrup.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with Dairy-Free Core Blend cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP No pumpkin pie spice? Use 1 teaspoon cinnamon, ¼ teaspoon ginger, and a pinch each of nutmeg, allspice and cloves.

PAIR

Dairy-free pumpkin bread, cornbread, or apple slices.

SERVE

Serve on a dairy-free Thanksgiving table beside the traditional candles.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

CHAPTER 10

Holiday & Celebration Candles

Edible candles were made for celebrations. This chapter follows the calendar, from Thanksgiving and Christmas through New Year's Eve, Valentine's Day, spring brunches, summer barbecues, Halloween and birthdays. Each candle is designed to anchor a holiday table, and many of them appear in the complete party plans in Part Four. Several use shaped molds (hearts, trees, spheres); flexible silicone molds release best, and shaped candles need an extra 30 minutes in the fridge.

RECIPES 129–150

RECIPE 129

V GF NF

Sage, Cranberry & Orange Thanksgiving Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

All the flavors of the Thanksgiving table in one candle: earthy sage, tart cranberries and bright orange zest. It's festive, beautiful and the perfect partner for warm dinner rolls.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1½ tablespoons finely chopped fresh sage, patted dry
- 2 tablespoons dried cranberries (20 g), finely chopped
- Finely grated zest of 1 orange
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- 3 small sage leaves, to decorate
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt and orange zest until creamy. Fold in the chopped sage and cranberries.
2. Press the sage leaves flat against the inside wall of the mold before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Chop the cranberries finely; they're sticky, so a lightly oiled knife helps.

PAIR

Warm dinner rolls, cornbread, or the Skillet Cornbread (Bread B5).

SERVE

Set it in the center of the Thanksgiving table on a wooden board ringed with dinner rolls.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 130

V GF NF

Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Nutty brown butter, warm pumpkin pie spice and a touch of maple. It tastes like the first slice of pumpkin pie, and smells even better as it melts.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, divided
- 1½ teaspoons pumpkin pie spice
- 1 tablespoon pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon powdered sugar (8 g)
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Cut ½ cup (113 g) of the butter into cubes and leave to soften to 65°F (18°C). Brown the remaining ½ cup (113 g) in a small pan until nutty and golden, 4 to 6 minutes. Pour into a bowl with all the brown bits, stir in the pumpkin pie spice, then cool and chill until soft-set, 20 to 30 minutes.
2. Beat the brown butter, softened butter, powdered sugar and salt until light. Beat in the maple syrup a teaspoon at a time.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Adding the spice to the warm brown butter "blooms" it, deepening the flavor. Make sure the butter has fully cooled before mixing.

PAIR

Pumpkin bread, cornbread, or cinnamon raisin bread.

SERVE

Serve at the dessert table with pumpkin bread, apple slices and gingersnaps.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 131

V GF NF

Thanksgiving Stuffing Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Everything you love about the stuffing: sage, thyme, celery, onion and black pepper. It turns any bread into stuffing-flavored bread, and it's a real conversation starter.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon butter, for cooking
- 1 small celery stalk, very finely diced
- 1 small shallot, very finely diced
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh sage
- 1 teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- ½ teaspoon celery salt
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the 1 tablespoon butter in a small skillet over medium heat. Add the celery and shallot and cook for 5 to 6 minutes, until soft and the pan is dry. Cool completely.
2. Beat the softened butter with the celery salt and pepper until creamy. Fold in the cooked vegetables, sage and thyme.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Cook the celery and shallot until all their moisture has gone; raw vegetables would make the candle weep.

PAIR

Dinner rolls, cornbread, or herb bread.

SERVE

A fun addition to the Thanksgiving table beside the turkey, with plenty of rolls.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 132

V GF NF

Turkey-Day Herb Butter Candle

Makes 1 pillar candle • Serves 12 to 16 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 5 hours • Burn about 60 to 90 minutes

A big pillar candle for a big crowd, flavored with the classic poultry herbs of sage, rosemary and thyme. Spoon the melted butter over sliced turkey for the juiciest plate of the year.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups (4 sticks / 454 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh sage
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh rosemary
- 1 tablespoon fresh thyme leaves
- 1 garlic clove, finely grated
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- 1½ teaspoons fine sea salt (8 g)
- ½ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 4 tablespoons (50 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Make sure all the herbs are completely dry before chopping. Beat the butter with the garlic, lemon zest, salt and pepper until creamy, then fold in the herbs.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a 20 to 24 oz (600 to 700 ml) silicone pillar mold or tall paper cup and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 3 hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 2 hours more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Big candles need longer chilling. Make this one the day before and let it chill overnight; it'll be perfectly firm on the day.

PAIR

Dinner rolls, sliced turkey, and mashed potatoes.

SERVE

Set the candle on a large platter surrounded by sliced turkey, and let guests spoon the butter over their slices.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 133

V GF NF

Gingerbread Spice Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Molasses, ginger, cinnamon and cloves: this candle tastes like a gingerbread cookie, and fills the room with the smell of Christmas baking as it melts.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons dark brown sugar (24 g), finely sifted
- 1 tablespoon molasses
- 1½ teaspoons ground ginger
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ground cloves
- ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the brown sugar, spices and salt for 2 minutes, until light. Beat in the molasses a little at a time until evenly colored.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Molasses is thick and sticky; warm the spoon under hot water first and it will slide right off.

PAIR

Gingerbread cookies, brioche, or sliced pears.

SERVE

Serve on Christmas Eve with gingerbread cookies, pears and mugs of hot cocoa.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 134

V GF NF

Candy Cane White Chocolate Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Creamy white chocolate, cool peppermint and crushed candy canes in red and white. It's festive, pretty and a favorite with children.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) good white chocolate, finely chopped
- ¼ teaspoon pure peppermint extract
- 2 candy canes, finely crushed
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Melt the white chocolate gently and cool it to 84 to 86°F (29 to 30°C).
2. Beat the butter with the peppermint extract and salt until light. With the mixer on low, pour in the white chocolate and beat until smooth.
3. Scatter the crushed candy canes inside the empty mold and roll them around to coat the sides before packing.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Crushed candy canes absorb moisture and turn sticky. Crush them and coat the mold just before packing, and keep the finished candle well wrapped in the fridge.

PAIR

Chocolate cookies, brownies, or shortbread.

SERVE

Serve on a Christmas dessert table with brownies, cookies and hot chocolate.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 135

V GF NF

Mulled Wine & Orange Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 30 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Red wine simmered with orange, cinnamon, clove and star anise until it becomes a glossy syrup, then beaten into butter. It's rosy-colored and tastes like a cup of mulled wine by the fire.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (240 ml) dry red wine
- 1 strip orange peel
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 2 cloves
- 1 star anise
- 1 tablespoon light brown sugar
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- Finely grated zest of ½ orange
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Simmer the wine, orange peel, spices and brown sugar in a small saucepan until reduced to about 1½ tablespoons of syrup, 15 to 20 minutes. Strain and cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the orange zest and salt until creamy. Beat in the mulled wine syrup a teaspoon at a time.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Watch the syrup closely toward the end of reducing; once it's thick, it can burn quickly.

PAIR

Panettone, brioche, or dark rye.

SERVE

Serve at a Christmas party with cheese, nuts, clementines and glasses of mulled wine.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 136

V GF NF

Eggnog Nutmeg Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Freshly grated nutmeg, vanilla and a splash of rum: the flavors of eggnog. It's creamy, warm and gently spiced.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 tablespoons powdered sugar (24 g)
- ½ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg, plus extra to finish
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 1 teaspoon dark rum or ½ teaspoon rum extract
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, nutmeg, cinnamon and salt until light and creamy. Beat in the rum and vanilla.
2. After lighting the finished candle, grate a little extra nutmeg over the top.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Freshly grated whole nutmeg is far more aromatic than ground. A small rasp grater works perfectly.

PAIR

Brioche, panettone, or gingerbread cookies.

SERVE

Serve with glasses of eggnog and a platter of holiday cookies.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 137

V GF NF

Rosemary Christmas Tree Candle

Makes 1 tree-shaped candle • Serves 8 to 10 • Clean-Burn Core (shaped) • Active 40 minutes • Chill 4 hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

A butter candle shaped like a Christmas tree, covered in rosemary "needles" and studded with cranberry "ornaments." It's the most festive candle in the book, and it's easier than it looks.

INGREDIENTS

- 1¼ cups (2½ sticks / 283 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons very finely chopped fresh rosemary, plus 6 to 8 sprigs for decorating
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 12 to 15 dried cranberries
- 1 primed food-safe wick, cut to 6 in (15 cm)
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter, for the Clean-Burn Core

METHOD

1. Make a cone mold: roll a sheet of parchment into a cone about 6 in (15 cm) tall and 3½ in (9 cm) wide at the base, tape it securely, and trim the base flat. Stand it point-down in a tall glass.
2. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy, then fold in the chopped rosemary.
3. Grease a wide straw with clarified butter and stand it in the center of the cone. Pipe or spoon the butter around the straw, tapping the glass to settle it. Smooth the base and chill for 2 hours.
4. Twist out the straw, stand the wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill for 1 hour more.
5. Peel away the parchment and set the tree upright on a serving plate. Press small rosemary sprig tips all over the outside, pointing downward like branches, and dot with cranberries. Chill for 30 minutes.
6. Trim the wick at the tip of the tree to ¼ in (6 mm), light it, and let it form a small pool before dipping.

FIRST-TRY TIP The tree's narrow top melts faster than a standard candle; light it as guests sit down and enjoy it within 45 minutes.

PAIR

Warm dinner rolls, focaccia, or a ring of pull-apart bread.

SERVE

Set it on a cake stand ringed with the Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath (Bread B3) for an unforgettable Christmas centerpiece.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 138

V GF NF

Christmas Morning Cranberry-Orange Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Bright, sweet and tangy, this candle is made for Christmas morning, when the house smells of coffee and there are warm rolls on the table.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup (about 5 g) freeze-dried cranberries, ground to a powder
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- Finely grated zest of 1 orange
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 tablespoon dried cranberries, finely chopped
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the cranberry powder, powdered sugar, orange zest and salt until light and evenly pink. Fold in the chopped dried cranberries.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Make this candle on Christmas Eve and keep it in the fridge; in the morning, all you have to do is light it.

PAIR

Cinnamon rolls, croissants, or orange-cranberry scones.

SERVE

Serve with cinnamon rolls, fresh oranges and coffee on Christmas morning.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 139

V GF NF

Champagne & Chive Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

A reduction of Champagne or sparkling wine gives this candle an elegant, delicate flavor, and fresh chives keep it light. It's the perfect start to a New Year's Eve party.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (240 ml) Champagne or dry sparkling wine
- 1 small shallot, very finely minced
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons finely sliced fresh chives
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt (4 g)
- Pinch of white pepper
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Simmer the Champagne and shallot in a small saucepan until reduced to about 1 tablespoon, 12 to 15 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the salt and white pepper until creamy. Beat in the Champagne reduction, then fold in the chives.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Open a bottle for the reduction and you have an excuse to pour a glass for the cook.

PAIR

Blinis, toasted brioche, or thin crackers.

SERVE

Serve with smoked salmon, crème fraîche, blinis and caviar or salmon roe, and plenty of bubbles.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 140

V GF NF

Gold-Leaf Truffle Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Black truffle butter and a shimmering coat of edible gold leaf: this is the most glamorous candle in the book. Make it for New Year's Eve, an anniversary or any night that calls for something special.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup (57 g) black truffle butter, softened
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 2 to 3 sheets edible gold leaf (23 or 24 karat)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter, truffle butter and salt until smooth.
2. Once the candle has been unmolded and is still cold, lay the gold leaf against its sides, pressing gently with a soft dry brush. Keep the gold on the lower two-thirds of the candle. Chill for 15 minutes before lighting.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Gold leaf is extremely delicate and sticks to fingers. Handle it with tweezers or a soft brush, and work away from drafts.

PAIR

Crostini, thin slices of baguette, or blinis.

SERVE

Serve at midnight with Champagne, oysters and crostini.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 141

V NF

Lunar New Year Mandarin & Sesame Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Mandarins symbolize good fortune at Lunar New Year. This candle combines their sweet zest with toasted sesame, ginger and a touch of soy for a savory-sweet candle that's bright and festive.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- Finely grated zest of 2 mandarins or clementines
- 1 teaspoon finely grated fresh ginger, squeezed of excess juice
- 1 teaspoon soy sauce
- ½ teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 1 tablespoon toasted sesame seeds, divided
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the mandarin zest, ginger, soy sauce, sesame oil and salt until smooth. Fold in 2 teaspoons of the sesame seeds.
2. Scatter the remaining sesame seeds inside the empty mold before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Use tamari instead of soy sauce to make this candle gluten-free.

PAIR

Steamed buns, scallion pancakes, or sesame flatbread.

SERVE

Serve with dumplings, spring rolls and a bowl of mandarins for good luck.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 142

V GF NF

Red Velvet Valentine's Candle

Makes 1 heart-shaped candle • Serves 4 to 6 • Clean-Burn Core (shaped) • Active 30 minutes • Chill 3½ hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

A heart-shaped candle made for Valentine's Day: chocolatey, vanilla-scented and a deep ruby red from beet powder (with no artificial coloring). It's romantic, delicious and gorgeous.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 oz (56 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 teaspoons beet powder
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick, cut to 4 in (10 cm)
- 1½ tablespoons (20 g) clarified butter, for the Clean-Burn Core

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C).
2. Beat the butter with the beet powder, powdered sugar, vanilla and salt until light and evenly red. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate and beat until glossy.
3. Grease a wide straw and stand it in the center of a 4 in (10 cm) silicone heart mold, about 2 in (5 cm) deep. Spoon in the butter around the straw, tapping the mold to settle it. Smooth the top and chill for 2 hours.
4. Twist out the straw, stand the wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill for 1½ hours more.
5. Press the heart out of the mold onto a heatproof plate. Trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm), light, and give it 10 minutes to form a pool.

FIRST-TRY TIP Beet powder gives a natural red color with no beet flavor once it's mixed with chocolate. Look for it in health-food stores.

PAIR

Strawberries, brioche, shortbread hearts, or raspberries.

SERVE

Serve on a small board for two with strawberries, raspberries and a glass of Champagne.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 143

V GF

Rose & Pink Peppercorn Heart Candle

Makes 1 heart-shaped candle • Serves 4 to 6 • Direct Wick (shaped) • Active 25 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 30 to 45 minutes

A savory Valentine's candle: delicate rose, sweet pink peppercorns and flaky salt. It's pretty, unexpected and lovely with bread and cheese.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 teaspoons pink peppercorns, lightly crushed
- ¼ teaspoon rose water
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 teaspoon dried edible rose petals, crumbled, plus a few whole petals
- 1 primed food-safe wick, cut to 4 in (10 cm)

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the pink peppercorns, rose water and salt until smooth. Fold in the crumbled rose petals.
2. Press a few whole rose petals into the base of a 4 in (10 cm) silicone heart mold. Spoon in the butter, pressing firmly and tapping to remove air. Smooth the top.
3. Push a chopstick down the center to within ½ in (12 mm) of the bottom, twist it out and slide in the wick. Pinch the butter closed. Chill for 2½ hours.
4. Press the heart out of the mold onto a heatproof plate, petal-side up. Trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm), light, and give it 10 minutes to form a pool.

FIRST-TRY TIP Pink peppercorns are related to cashews; leave them out if anyone has a tree-nut allergy.

PAIR

Baguette, crackers, or radishes.

SERVE

Serve as a savory starter for a Valentine's dinner with soft cheeses and a glass of rosé.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 144

V GF NF

Hot Cross Bun Spice Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

The spiced, fruity flavor of hot cross buns: cinnamon, nutmeg, allspice, orange zest and currants. It's lovely for Easter breakfast and spring brunches.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon ground allspice
- Finely grated zest of 1 orange
- 2 tablespoons currants (20 g), finely chopped
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, spices, orange zest and salt until light. Fold in the currants.
2. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
3. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Soak the currants in hot water for 5 minutes, then dry them thoroughly on paper towels before chopping; they'll be plumper and easier to chop.

PAIR

Hot cross buns, brioche, or raisin toast.

SERVE

Serve on Easter morning with toasted hot cross buns, fruit and coffee.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 145

V GF NF

Honey Lavender Brunch Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Floral lavender and golden honey make a gentle, elegant candle that's perfect for Mother's Day, baby showers and spring brunches.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 2 tablespoons honey
- ½ teaspoon dried culinary lavender buds, finely ground
- Finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- A few lavender sprigs, to decorate
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the ground lavender, lemon zest and salt until creamy. Beat in the honey a teaspoon at a time.
2. Press the lavender sprigs flat against the inside wall of the mold before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Grind the lavender to a fine powder; whole buds can taste soapy and look like specks of dirt.

PAIR

Scones, brioche, or lemon pound cake.

SERVE

Serve at a Mother's Day brunch with scones, fresh berries and a pot of tea.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 146

V GF NF

Backyard BBQ Rub Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Brown sugar, smoked paprika, garlic, onion and black pepper: a classic barbecue rub in butter. It's smoky, sweet and perfect for grilled corn and cookout bread.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 tablespoon light brown sugar (12 g), finely sifted
- 2 teaspoons smoked paprika
- ½ teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon onion powder
- ½ teaspoon mustard powder
- ½ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick

METHOD

1. Mix the brown sugar, spices and salt in a small bowl, pressing out any lumps. Add to the butter and beat until evenly colored.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Because this candle contains sugar, keep the wick trimmed short and the flame small. If you'd like to make it ahead in larger batches, switch to the Clean-Burn Core.

PAIR

Texas toast, cornbread, or grilled corn on the cob.

SERVE

Serve at a summer barbecue with grilled corn, ribs and coleslaw. Keep it in the shade and out of the breeze.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 147

V GF NF

Elote Street Corn Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Mexican street corn is slathered in creamy, tangy sauce, cotija cheese, chili and lime. This candle captures it perfectly, and it's spectacular brushed onto hot grilled corn.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ⅓ cup (30 g) finely crumbled cotija cheese
- 1 teaspoon chili powder, plus extra to finish
- Finely grated zest of 2 limes
- 1 tablespoon finely chopped fresh cilantro, patted dry
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the chili powder, lime zest and salt until evenly colored. Fold in the cotija and cilantro.
2. After lighting, dust a little extra chili powder over the top.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Cotija is a dry, crumbly Mexican cheese that holds its shape in butter. Feta is the best substitute.

PAIR

Grilled corn on the cob, corn tortillas, or cornbread.

SERVE

Set it out with a platter of hot grilled corn and let guests roll their corn through the melted pool.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 148

GF NF

Midnight Black Halloween Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

A jet-black candle for Halloween, colored naturally with squid ink and flavored with black garlic. It's dramatic, spooky and surprisingly delicious.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon squid or cuttlefish ink
- 4 black garlic cloves, mashed to a paste
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt (3 g)
- Black sesame seeds, for coating
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Mash the squid ink, black garlic and salt together. Add the butter a third at a time, beating well, until evenly black.
2. Scatter black sesame seeds inside the empty mold and roll them around to coat the sides before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Squid ink is sold in small jars or sachets at Italian delis and fishmongers. It tastes subtly of the sea, which pairs beautifully with the sweet black garlic.

PAIR

Sourdough, pumpernickel, or orange-colored crackers.

SERVE

Serve on a black plate with pumpkin-shaped bread rolls and spooky decorations for a Halloween party.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 149

V GF NF

Birthday Cake Sprinkle Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Vanilla, almond extract and a coat of rainbow sprinkles: this candle tastes like birthday cake frosting. Kids absolutely love it, and blowing it out makes the perfect birthday moment.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ¼ cup powdered sugar (32 g)
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon almond extract (optional)
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 3 tablespoons rainbow sprinkles, for coating
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, vanilla, almond extract (if using) and salt for 2 minutes, until light and fluffy.
2. Scatter the sprinkles inside the empty mold and roll them around to coat the sides before packing.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Keep the sprinkles only on the outside of the candle; inside the butter their colors bleed. Check sprinkle labels for gluten if needed. Almond extract is usually made from bitter almond oil; leave it out for nut allergies.

PAIR

Brioche, vanilla cake squares, strawberries, or graham crackers.

SERVE

Serve at a birthday party with cake squares, fruit and sweet bread, and let the birthday person make a wish before you blow it out.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 150

V GF NF

Buffalo Wing Game Day Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Tangy hot sauce, butter and a little garlic: Buffalo sauce is mostly butter anyway, which makes it a natural for a candle. Serve it with celery and blue cheese for the full game-day experience.

INGREDIENTS

- ⅓ cup (80 ml) cayenne pepper hot sauce
- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- ½ teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced celery leaves, patted dry
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core

METHOD

1. Simmer the hot sauce in a small saucepan until reduced to about 1½ tablespoons, 5 to 6 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Beat the butter with the garlic powder and paprika until creamy. Beat in the hot sauce reduction a teaspoon at a time, until evenly orange. Fold in the celery leaves.
3. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP Reducing the hot sauce concentrates its heat and flavor and removes the water. Open a window; it's punchy while it simmers.

PAIR

Celery and carrot sticks, soft pretzels, or cornbread.

SERVE

Serve on game day with celery, carrot sticks, blue cheese dip, wings and cold beer.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

PART THREE

Breads, Bowls & Boards

An edible candle is only half the story; the other half is what you dip into it. This part of the book covers the breads and dippers that suit each family of candles, how to turn any loaf into a bread bowl safely, eight bonus recipes for breads and dippers made to go with candles, and a simple method for building a candle board that looks abundant every time.

The Bread Pairing Guide

There are no rules, only good matches. Use this chart as a starting point.

Candle family	Best breads	Best non-bread dippers
Classic & salted (Chapter 1)	Sourdough, baguette, country bread	Radishes, cucumber, boiled new potatoes
Herb garden (Chapter 2)	Focaccia, baguette, brioche	Asparagus, sugar snap peas, roasted potatoes
Garlic & onion (Chapter 3)	Ciabatta, Italian bread, pull-apart rolls	Roasted potatoes, grilled vegetables, steak
Cheese (Chapter 4)	Sourdough, rye, pretzel bites, walnut bread	Apple and pear slices, grapes, celery
Around the world (Chapter 5)	Pita, naan, flatbread, milk bread, tortillas	Grilled shrimp, roasted carrots, corn
Smoky & tallow (Chapter 6)	Cornbread, sourdough, Texas toast	Roast potatoes, sliced steak, grilled corn
Sweet (Chapter 7)	Brioche, challah, scones, waffles, pancakes	Strawberries, apple slices, banana
Chocolate (Chapter 8)	Brioche, shortbread, pretzel rods	Strawberries, orange segments, marshmallows
Dairy-free (Chapter 9)	Sourdough, focaccia, baguette (check labels)	Crudités, roasted vegetables, fruit

> HOW MUCH BREAD? Plan on 2 to 3 oz (60 to 85 g) of bread per guest for each candle you serve as a starter, or about half a standard baguette for every three guests. With a full meal, one standard candle serves 8 to 10.

How to Turn Any Loaf into a Bread Bowl

A candle glowing inside a hollowed loaf is the classic way to serve it, and it's easy with any round, crusty loaf about 8 in (20 cm) across or larger.

1. **Choose a sturdy loaf.** A crusty round sourdough or country loaf, at least a day old, holds its shape best. Soft sandwich-style loaves collapse.
2. **Cut a lid.** Using a serrated knife, cut a circle in the top of the loaf about 1 in (2.5 cm) wider than your candle, angling the knife slightly inward.
3. **Hollow it out.** Pull out the soft crumb with your fingers, leaving walls and a base about 1 in (2.5 cm) thick. Tear the crumb and lid into chunks for dipping.
4. **Toast it (optional but recommended).** Brush the inside with olive oil or melted butter and bake at 350°F (180°C) for 10 minutes. A toasted bowl soaks up butter without going soggy.
5. **Set the candle.** Stand the candle in the center on a small heatproof saucer or a round of foil, so it sits level. The top of the candle should be level with, or just above, the rim of the loaf.

KEEP THE FLAME CLEAR OF THE CRUST For safety, make the hollow wide enough that there is at least 1 in (2.5 cm) of space between the wick and the bread on every side, and never let the flame sit below the rim of the loaf. Bread can toast and scorch close to a flame.

Bonus Breads & Dippers

B1. No-Knead Crusty Bread Bowl

Makes 1 large round loaf · Active 20 minutes · Rising 14 to 20 hours · Baking 50 minutes

The easiest bread you'll ever make: no kneading, no special skills, just time. It bakes into a deeply browned, crackling crust that's perfect for a bread bowl.

- 3 cups (400 g) bread flour, plus extra for dusting
- 1½ teaspoons fine sea salt (8 g)
- ¼ teaspoon instant yeast (1 g)
- 1⅓ cups (300 ml) cool water

1. In a large bowl, mix the flour, salt and yeast. Add the water and stir until a shaggy, sticky dough forms, with no dry flour left. Cover and leave at room temperature for 12 to 18 hours, until bubbly and more than doubled.
2. Turn the dough onto a well-floured surface and fold it over on itself a few times to form a round ball. Place it seam-side down on a sheet of parchment, dust with flour, cover with a towel and let rise for 1½ to 2 hours.
3. About 45 minutes before baking, put a 5 to 6 quart (5 to 6 liter) Dutch oven with its lid in the oven and heat to 450°F (230°C).
4. Lift the dough on its parchment into the hot pot, cover and bake for 30 minutes. Uncover and bake for 15 to 20 minutes more, until deep brown.
5. Cool on a rack for at least 1 hour before cutting, then hollow it out as above.

B2. Overnight Rosemary Focaccia

Makes one 9 × 13 in (23 × 33 cm) focaccia · Active 20 minutes · Rising overnight plus 2 to 3 hours · Baking 25 minutes

Golden, crisp-bottomed and bubbly, with plenty of olive oil and rosemary. Cut into fingers, it's the ideal dipper for herb and garlic candles.

- 4 cups (500 g) bread flour or all-purpose flour
- 2 teaspoons fine sea salt (10 g)
- 1 teaspoon instant yeast (3 g)
- 2 cups (450 ml) lukewarm water
- 6 tablespoons (90 ml) extra-virgin olive oil, divided
- 2 sprigs rosemary, leaves picked
- 1 teaspoon flaky sea salt

1. In a large bowl, whisk the flour, salt and yeast. Add the water and stir with a spatula until no dry flour remains. Pour 2 tablespoons of the oil over the dough, turn to coat, cover and refrigerate for 12 to 24 hours.
2. Pour 3 tablespoons of the oil into a 9 × 13 in (23 × 33 cm) pan. Tip the dough in, turn it to coat in the oil, and leave it at room temperature for 2 to 3 hours, until puffy and nearly doubled. Gently stretch it to the corners once during this time.
3. Heat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Drizzle the remaining oil over the dough. With oiled fingers, press dimples all over it, right down to the pan. Scatter with the rosemary and flaky salt.
4. Bake for 25 to 30 minutes, until deep golden on top and crisp underneath. Cool in the pan for 10 minutes, then transfer to a rack. Cut into fingers to serve.

B3. Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath

Serves 10 to 12 · Active 25 minutes · Rising 45 minutes · Baking 25 minutes

Balls of dough rolled in garlic-herb butter and baked in a ring pan. Turned out onto a platter, the wreath has a hole in the middle that's just the right size for a candle.

- 2 lb (900 g) store-bought pizza dough or frozen bread dough, thawed
- ½ cup (1 stick / 113 g) unsalted butter, melted
- 3 garlic cloves, finely grated
- 3 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley
- ½ cup (45 g) finely grated Parmesan
- ½ teaspoon fine sea salt

1. Generously butter a 10 to 12 cup (2.5 to 3 liter) Bundt or ring pan.
2. Stir the garlic, parsley and salt into the melted butter. Put the Parmesan in a separate bowl.
3. Pinch off pieces of dough the size of a walnut and roll them into balls. Dip each ball in the garlic butter, roll it in the Parmesan, and layer the balls loosely in the pan.
4. Cover and let rise in a warm place for 30 to 45 minutes, until puffy. Meanwhile, heat the oven to 350°F (180°C).
5. Bake for 25 to 30 minutes, until golden and cooked through. Cool for 5 minutes, then turn out onto a large platter. Set a candle on a small heatproof saucer in the center.

B4. Quick Beer Bread

Makes 1 loaf · Active 10 minutes · Baking 50 minutes

No yeast, no rising and no kneading: just stir, pour and bake. It has a crunchy, buttery top and a soft, slightly malty crumb that's ideal with cheese and smoky candles.

- 3 cups (375 g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tablespoon baking powder
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 1½ cups (355 ml / one 12 oz bottle) beer, at room temperature
- ¼ cup (½ stick / 57 g) unsalted butter, melted

1. Heat the oven to 375°F (190°C) and butter a 9 × 5 in (23 × 13 cm) loaf pan.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, salt and sugar in a large bowl. Pour in the beer and stir just until combined; the batter will be thick and lumpy.
3. Scrape the batter into the pan and pour the melted butter evenly over the top.
4. Bake for 45 to 55 minutes, until golden and a skewer inserted in the center comes out clean. Cool for 10 minutes before slicing.

B5. Skillet Cornbread

Serves 8 · Active 15 minutes · Baking 20 minutes

Crisp-edged, tender and just slightly sweet. Cornbread loves smoky, spicy, honey and holiday candles.

- 1 cup (140 g) fine or medium cornmeal
- 1 cup (125 g) all-purpose flour
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 1 tablespoon baking powder
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt
- 1¼ cups (300 ml) buttermilk
- 2 large eggs
- ¼ cup (½ stick / 57 g) unsalted butter, melted, plus 1 tablespoon for the skillet

1. Put a 10 in (25 cm) cast-iron skillet in the oven and heat it to 425°F (220°C).
2. Whisk the cornmeal, flour, sugar, baking powder, baking soda and salt in a large bowl. In another bowl, whisk the buttermilk, eggs and melted butter. Pour the wet ingredients into the dry and stir just until combined.
3. Carefully remove the hot skillet, add the 1 tablespoon butter and swirl to coat. Pour in the batter; it should sizzle.
4. Bake for 20 to 25 minutes, until golden and a skewer comes out clean. Cut into wedges or fingers to serve.

B6. Soft Pretzel Bites

Makes about 80 bites · Active 45 minutes · Rising 1 hour · Baking 15 minutes

Chewy, salty and golden-brown: soft pretzel bites are the best dipper ever made for cheese, mustard and beer candles.

- 1½ cups (360 ml) warm water
- 1 tablespoon sugar
- 2¼ teaspoons (7 g / one packet) instant yeast
- 4½ cups (560 g) all-purpose flour
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt
- 4 tablespoons (57 g) unsalted butter, melted
- 10 cups (2.4 liters) water and ⅔ cup (150 g) baking soda, for boiling
- 1 large egg, beaten with 1 tablespoon water
- Coarse pretzel salt or flaky sea salt

1. In a large bowl or stand mixer, stir the warm water, sugar and yeast together. Add the flour, salt and melted butter and knead for 5 to 7 minutes, until smooth and elastic. Cover and let rise for 1 hour, until doubled.
2. Heat the oven to 425°F (220°C) and line two baking sheets with parchment. Bring the 10 cups of water and the baking soda to a boil in a large pot (add the soda slowly; it will foam).
3. Divide the dough into 8 pieces. Roll each into a rope about 1 in (2.5 cm) thick and cut into 1 in (2.5 cm) bites.
4. Boil the bites in batches for 20 to 30 seconds, lift out with a slotted spoon, and arrange on the baking sheets.
5. Brush with the egg wash, sprinkle with salt and bake for 12 to 15 minutes, until deep golden brown. Serve warm.

B7. Cinnamon Sugar Brioche Dippers

Serves 8 · Active 10 minutes · Baking 12 minutes

Buttery brioche fingers baked until crisp outside and soft inside, then rolled in cinnamon sugar. Made for sweet and chocolate candles.

- 1 brioche loaf (about 1 lb / 450 g), a day old
- 4 tablespoons (57 g) unsalted butter, melted
- ¼ cup (50 g) sugar
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon

1. Heat the oven to 375°F (190°C) and line a baking sheet with parchment.
2. Slice the brioche ¾ in (2 cm) thick, then cut each slice into fingers.
3. Brush the fingers on all sides with the melted butter and arrange on the baking sheet.
4. Bake for 10 to 12 minutes, turning once, until golden and crisp at the edges.
5. Mix the sugar and cinnamon in a shallow dish and roll the warm dippers in it. Serve warm or at room temperature.

B8. The Gluten-Free & Low-Carb Dipper Board

Not everyone eats bread, but everyone should be able to dip. Set these out on their own board, with their own serving utensils, beside the main spread.

Gluten-free breads and crackers: a good gluten-free baguette or sourdough (warm it in the oven for 5 minutes), rice crackers, seeded crackers and corn tortilla chips.

Crisp vegetables: radishes, cucumber spears, endive leaves, celery, bell pepper strips, sugar snap peas and blanched asparagus.

Warm vegetables: boiled baby potatoes, roasted potato wedges, roasted carrots, grilled corn and roasted cauliflower.

For sweet candles: strawberries, apple and pear slices, orange segments, banana coins, pineapple chunks and gluten-free shortbread.

For savory protein: grilled shrimp, sliced steak, chicken skewers and cubes of cheese.

Building the Candle Board

A candle board is a wooden board or platter built around one or more edible candles. It looks abundant, it's easy to assemble, and it turns a candle into a complete appetizer course.

1. **Choose the board.** A large wooden board or tray at least 16 in (40 cm) across, with enough room for the candle and plenty of food around it.
2. **Place the candle first.** Set it on a small heatproof saucer slightly off-center, so it's easy to reach from every side. Leave at least 4 in (10 cm) of clear space around it.
3. **Add the bread.** Fan sliced bread and pile torn chunks in two or three generous groups.
4. **Add color and crunch.** Tuck in vegetables, fruit or crackers that suit the candle (see the Pairing Guide).
5. **Add something salty and something sweet.** Olives, cornichons, nuts or cured meats for savory candles; berries, honey or chocolate for sweet ones.
6. **Finish with fresh herbs or flowers,** keeping anything dry, leafy or papery well away from the flame.
7. **Label it.** A small card with the candle's name and main allergens helps guests choose.

> ONE BOARD, ONE CANDLE When you serve more than one candle, give each its own board. Guests dip more neatly, flavors stay distinct, and a dairy-free or nut-free candle stays safe for the guests who need it.

PART FOUR

Holiday & Party Plans

These ten plans take the guesswork out of hosting. Each one gives you the candles, the breads and dippers, a few simple dishes to round out the table, and a timeline that puts almost all of the work days ahead, so on the day you only have to unmold, light and enjoy. Recipe numbers refer to the candles in Part Two; bread numbers refer to the bonus breads in Part Three.

> **HOSTING WITH FLAMES** Before every party, choose where each candle will sit: on a heatproof board, away from napkins, centerpieces, curtains and hanging decorations, and out of reach of small children and pets. Keep a candle snuffer on the table, and assign one adult to keep an eye on the candles while they're lit.

Plan 1: The Thanksgiving Harvest Table

Serves 12 · Make-ahead level: almost everything

THE CANDLES

- **Turkey-Day Herb Butter Candle** (recipe 132), as the centerpiece beside the turkey
- **Sage, Cranberry & Orange Thanksgiving Candle** (recipe 129), at the other end of the table
- **Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle** (recipe 130), for the dessert table
- **Pumpkin Spice Plant Butter Candle** (recipe 128), for dairy-free guests

Breads & dippers: two dozen warm dinner rolls, Skillet Cornbread (Bread B5), pumpkin bread and apple slices for dessert.

Round out the table: roast turkey, mashed potatoes, green beans, roasted squash and a cranberry relish.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 1 month before:** make the Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle and the Pumpkin Spice Plant Butter Candle; wrap and freeze.
- **3 days before:** make the Sage, Cranberry & Orange Candle and the Turkey-Day Pillar; refrigerate. Move frozen candles to the fridge the night before.
- **Thanksgiving morning:** bake the cornbread. Set the boards, saucers and snuffer in place on the table.
- **30 minutes before dinner:** warm the rolls. Unmold the candles and return them to the fridge.
- **As guests sit down:** set the candles on their boards, trim the wicks and light them.
- **Dessert:** light the pumpkin spice candles as the main course is cleared.

Table styling: a runner of autumn leaves (kept well away from the flames), small pumpkins and gourds, and warm amber glassware.

Plan 2: Christmas Eve Candlelight Supper

Serves 8 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Rosemary Christmas Tree Candle** (recipe 137), as the showpiece, ringed by the Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath (Bread B3)
- **Mulled Wine & Orange Candle** (recipe 135), with the cheese course
- **Gingerbread Spice Candle** (recipe 133), for dessert

Breads & dippers: the Garlic Pull-Apart Wreath (Bread B3), a baguette, gingerbread cookies, clementines and sliced pears.

Round out the table: a roast (beef, ham or a festive vegetable Wellington), roasted root vegetables, a green salad, and a cheese board.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Gingerbread Spice Candle; refrigerate or freeze.
- **2 days before:** make the Mulled Wine & Orange Candle.
- **The day before:** make the cone mold and the Christmas Tree Candle; keep it upright in its glass in the fridge.
- **Christmas Eve afternoon:** make and bake the pull-apart wreath. Decorate the Christmas Tree Candle with rosemary and cranberries.
- **At the table:** set the tree in the center of the wreath and light it as guests sit down.

Table styling: evergreen branches and pine cones down the center of the table (at least 12 in / 30 cm from any flame), with white linens and gold accents.

Plan 3: New Year's Eve Cocktail Party

Serves 20 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Champagne & Chive Candle** (recipe 139), two standard candles
- **Gold-Leaf Truffle Candle** (recipe 140), saved for the midnight toast
- **Cacio e Pepe Butter Candle** (recipe 45)
- **Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle** (recipe 103), for late-night sweets

Breads & dippers: blinis, crostini, thinly sliced baguette, grissini, strawberries and shortbread.

Round out the table: smoked salmon, oysters or shrimp cocktail, a charcuterie board and plenty of bubbles.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle.
- **2 days before:** make the Champagne & Chive Candles, the Cacio e Pepe Candle and the Gold-Leaf Truffle Candle (apply the gold leaf on the day).
- **Party afternoon:** slice the bread, toast the crostini, and apply the gold leaf.
- **When guests arrive:** light the Champagne and Cacio e Pepe candles.
- **10:30 p.m.:** bring out the chocolate candle.
- **11:45 p.m.:** light the Gold-Leaf Truffle Candle for the countdown.

Table styling: black and gold, with mirrored trays and glassware. Keep confetti and paper decorations far from the candles.

Plan 4: Valentine's Dinner for Two

Serves 2 · Make-ahead level: complete

THE CANDLES

- **Rose & Pink Peppercorn Heart Candle** (recipe 143), with the starter
- **Red Velvet Valentine's Candle** (recipe 142), for dessert

Breads & dippers: a warm baguette, radishes and soft cheese for the savory heart; strawberries, raspberries and shortbread hearts for the red velvet heart.

Round out the table: a simple main course (steak, pasta or roast fish), a green salad, and Champagne or rosé.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 1 week before:** make both heart candles and keep them wrapped in the fridge.
- **On the day:** wash and hull the berries and slice the bread.
- **At dinner:** light the savory heart with the starter, and the red velvet heart as you clear the main course.

Table styling: a small table, low lighting, a few loose rose petals (kept away from the flames) and your best glasses.

Plan 5: Easter & Spring Brunch

Serves 10 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Hot Cross Bun Spice Candle** (recipe 144)
- **Fines Herbes Butter Candle** (recipe 18)
- **Honey Lavender Brunch Candle** (recipe 145)

Breads & dippers: hot cross buns, brioche, scones, croissants and a basket of radishes and asparagus.

Round out the table: a quiche or frittata, smoked salmon, a fruit platter and a pot of good coffee.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Hot Cross Bun and Honey Lavender candles.
- **2 days before:** make the Fines Herbes candle.
- **Brunch morning:** bake or warm the pastries and bake the quiche.
- **As guests arrive:** unmold and light the candles.

Table styling: pastel linens, tulips or daffodils in low vases, and painted eggs in small bowls.

Plan 6: Fourth of July Backyard Barbecue

Serves 16 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Backyard BBQ Rub Candle** (recipe 146)
- **Elote Street Corn Candle** (recipe 147)
- **Texas Tallow & Black Pepper Candle** (recipe 80), which holds up best in warm weather

Breads & dippers: Texas toast, Skillet Cornbread (Bread B5), and a big platter of hot grilled corn.

Round out the table: burgers, ribs or brisket, coleslaw, potato salad and watermelon.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Backyard BBQ Rub and Texas Tallow candles.
- **2 days before:** make the Elote candle. Use the warm-room insurance tip (replace 2 tablespoons of butter with cocoa butter) for the butter candles.
- **Party morning:** bake the cornbread; keep the candles in a cooler with ice packs.
- **When the food comes off the grill:** set the candles out in the shade, light them, and enjoy them within 45 minutes.

> OUTDOOR CANDLES Heat and wind are the enemies of an edible candle. Set candles in a shaded, sheltered spot, on a tray in a bed of ice if it's very hot, and never near dry grass, paper plates or napkins. If the wind picks up, snuff the candles and serve the butter from a warm dish instead.

Plan 7: Halloween Party

Serves 12 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Midnight Black Halloween Candle** (recipe 148)
- **Smoked Gouda & Paprika Candle** (recipe 50)
- **Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle** (recipe 130)

Breads & dippers: pumpkin-shaped dinner rolls (tie each dough ball with kitchen twine in four places before baking to make the pumpkin ridges, then remove the twine once baked), pretzel bites (Bread B6), apple slices and orange cheddar.

Round out the table: chili or a hearty soup, roasted pumpkin seeds and a candy bowl.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle.
- **3 days before:** make the Midnight Black and Smoked Gouda candles.
- **Party day:** bake the pretzel bites and pumpkin rolls.
- **As guests arrive:** light the candles on black plates for maximum drama.

Table styling: black and orange, with small pumpkins and battery-operated lights. Keep spider webs, paper bats and costumes well away from the flames.

Plan 8: Game Day Spread

Serves 10 · Make-ahead level: complete

THE CANDLES

- **Buffalo Wing Game Day Candle** (recipe 150)
- **Jalapeño Popper Candle** (recipe 55)
- **Pub Cheddar & Ale Candle** (recipe 58)

Breads & dippers: Soft Pretzel Bites (Bread B6), Quick Beer Bread (Bread B4), celery and carrot sticks, and tortilla chips.

Round out the table: wings, sliders, nachos and blue cheese dip.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 3 days before:** make all three candles.
- **Game morning:** bake the pretzel bites and beer bread.
- **Kickoff:** light the candles. Relight with fresh candles at halftime if needed.

Table styling: team colors, a long low table within reach of the couch, and a dedicated candle-watcher.

Plan 9: A Birthday Celebration

Serves 12 · Make-ahead level: high

THE CANDLES

- **Birthday Cake Sprinkle Candle** (recipe 149), for the birthday wish
- **Strawberry Vanilla Blueberry Layered Candle** (recipe 102)
- **Garlic Bread Butter Candle** (recipe 42), for the savory table

Breads & dippers: brioche, Cinnamon Sugar Brioche Dippers (Bread B7), strawberries and vanilla cake squares; Italian bread for the garlic candle.

Round out the table: pizza or pasta, a big salad, and the birthday cake.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the Birthday Cake and Layered candles.
- **2 days before:** make the Garlic Bread candle.
- **Party morning:** bake the brioche dippers.
- **Cake time:** light the Birthday Cake Sprinkle Candle, sing, and let the birthday person make a wish before you blow it out (with a snuffer, of course).

Plan 10: The Candle Tasting Party (Any Time of Year)

Serves 8 to 12 · Make-ahead level: complete

This is the party I host most often, and it works in every season. Guests taste their way through a flight of candles, vote for a favorite, and go home with the leftovers (and the recipes).

THE CANDLES (CHOOSE FIVE)

- One classic: **Classic Sea Salt Butter Candle** (recipe 1) or **Cultured Butter & Fleur de Sel Candle** (recipe 3)
- One herb: **Rosemary & Sea Salt Butter Candle** (recipe 16)
- One garlic or cheese: **Roasted Garlic Butter Candle** (recipe 31) or **Cacio e Pepe Butter Candle** (recipe 45)
- One adventurous: **White Miso Butter Candle** (recipe 9), **Harissa Butter Candle** (recipe 62) or **Black Garlic Butter Candle** (recipe 32)
- One sweet: **Honey & Sea Salt Butter Candle** (recipe 87) or **Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle** (recipe 103)

Breads & dippers: a large basket of mixed breads (sourdough, baguette, rye and focaccia) and a board of crudités and fruit.

TIMELINE

- **Up to 2 weeks before:** make the dry-ingredient candles.
- **2 to 3 days before:** make the fresh-ingredient candles.
- **On the day:** buy the bread, make tasting cards with each candle's name and allergens, and set out pencils for voting.
- **At the party:** light the candles in order, from mildest to boldest, and finish with the sweet one.

> SCALING UP For larger parties, use the Sizing & Scaling chart in Part One: one pillar candle replaces two standard candles and burns for longer. Plan on one standard candle for every 6 to 8 guests as a starter, and one for every 10 guests alongside a full meal.

Conversion Charts

Butter

US measure	Sticks	Weight
1 tablespoon	⅛ stick	14 g
2 tablespoons	¼ stick	28 g
¼ cup	½ stick	57 g
½ cup	1 stick	113 g
¾ cup	1½ sticks	170 g
1 cup	2 sticks	227 g
1½ cups	3 sticks	340 g
2 cups	4 sticks (1 lb)	454 g

Common Candle Ingredients by Weight

Ingredient	1 tablespoon	¼ cup
Powdered sugar	8 g	32 g
Light or dark brown sugar (packed)	12 g	50 g
Honey or maple syrup	20 g	80 g
Finely grated Parmesan or Pecorino	5 g	22 g
Fine sea salt	15 g	60 g
Ghee or clarified butter (melted)	13 g	53 g
Food-grade cocoa butter (melted)	13 g	53 g
Refined coconut oil (melted)	13 g	54 g

Volume

US	Metric
1 teaspoon	5 ml
1 tablespoon	15 ml
¼ cup	60 ml
⅓ cup	80 ml

US	Metric
½ cup	120 ml
1 cup	240 ml

Temperatures

Fahrenheit	Celsius	Use
65 to 68°F	18 to 20°C	Softened butter for packing
84 to 90°F	29 to 32°C	Cooled melted chocolate (white, milk, dark)
95 to 105°F	35 to 40°C	Clarified butter for the Clean-Burn Core
100 to 110°F	38 to 43°C	Pouring ghee, tallow and cocoa butter blends
325°F	160°C	Toasting coconut "bacon"
350°F	180°C	Toasting bread bowls, pull-apart bread
375°F	190°C	Beer bread, brioche dippers
400°F	200°C	Roasting garlic and shallots
425°F	220°C	Focaccia, cornbread, pretzel bites
450°F	230°C	No-knead bread, roasting marrow bones

Recipe Finder

Every candle in the book at a glance, in recipe order, with its method and diet labels. A check mark means the candle is suitable as written.

No.	Recipe	Method	V	GF	DF	NF
1	Classic Sea Salt Butter Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
2	Black Pepper & Flaky Salt Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
3	Cultured Butter & Fleur de Sel Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
4	Brown Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
5	Everything Bagel Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
6	Lemon Pepper Butter Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
7	Smoked Salt & Paprika Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
8	Black Truffle Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
9	White Miso Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓			✓
10	Steakhouse Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core		✓		✓
11	Furikake & Sesame Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core				✓
12	Coriander & Orange Zest Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		✓
13	Mustard Seed & Dijon Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
14	Pink Peppercorn & Lime Candle	Direct Wick	✓	✓		
15	Classic Mini Candle Trio	Direct Wick (minis)	✓	✓		✓
16	Rosemary & Sea Salt Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
17	Maître d'Hôtel Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
18	Fines Herbes Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
19	Herbes de Provence & Lavender Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
20	Thyme & Lemon Zest Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
21	Dill & Chive Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
22	Basil Pesto Swirl Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		
23	Crispy Sage & Brown Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
24	Tarragon Béarnaise Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
25	Cilantro-Lime Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
26	Chimichurri Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
27	Chervil & Chive Spring Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
28	Bay Leaf & Juniper Candle	Poured	✓	✓		✓
29	Greek Oregano & Lemon Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
30	Three-Herb Garden Layered Candle	Layered	✓	✓		✓
31	Roasted Garlic Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
32	Black Garlic Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
33	Garlic Confit & Parsley Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
34	Caramelized Onion Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
35	French Onion Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
36	Shallot & Red Wine Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
37	Sour Cream & Onion Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
38	Roasted Red Pepper & Garlic Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
39	Sun-Dried Tomato & Garlic Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓
40	Wild Mushroom & Thyme Candle	Clean-Burn Core	✓	✓		✓

No.	Recipe	Method	V	GF	DF	NF
41	Spring Onion & Ginger Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
42	Garlic Bread Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
43	Roasted Shallot & Balsamic Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
44	Triple Allium Layered Candle	Layered	√	√		√
45	Cacio e Pepe Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
46	Aged White Cheddar & Chive Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
47	Gorgonzola, Honey & Walnut Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
48	Goat Cheese & Herb Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
49	Gruyère & Thyme Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
50	Smoked Gouda & Paprika Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
51	Pimento Cheese Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
52	Manchego & Quince Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
53	Feta, Oregano & Lemon Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
54	Pecorino, Lemon & Mint Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
55	Jalapeño Popper Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
56	Brie & Fig Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
57	Alpine Fondue Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
58	Pub Cheddar & Ale Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√			√
59	Pizza Night Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
60	Three-Cheese Layered Candle	Layered	√	√		√
61	Za'atar & Lemon Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
62	Harissa Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
63	Ras el Hanout & Honey Candle	Direct Wick	√	√		√
64	Tadka Ghee Candle	Poured	√	√		√
65	Yuzu Kosho Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
66	Gochujang Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√			√
67	Lemongrass, Lime Leaf & Chili Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
68	Chili-Lime Candle	Direct Wick	√	√		√
69	Cajun Butter Candle	Direct Wick	√	√		√
70	Jerk Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
71	Calabrian Chili & Honey Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
72	Smoky Romesco Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√			
73	Berbere Spiced Butter Candle	Poured	√	√		√
74	Five-Spice & Scallion Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
75	Café de Paris Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
76	Sumac & Pistachio Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
77	Bacon Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
78	Maple Bacon Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
79	Rosemary Beef Tallow Candle	Poured		√	√	√
80	Texas Tallow & Black Pepper Candle	Poured		√	√	√
81	'Nduja Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
82	Chorizo & Smoked Paprika Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
83	Pancetta & Black Pepper Carbonara Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
84	Duck Fat & Thyme Candle	Poured		√	√	√
85	Chipotle Adobo Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
86	Roasted Bone Marrow & Parsley Candle	Clean-Burn Core		√		√

No.	Recipe	Method	V	GF	DF	NF
87	Honey & Sea Salt Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
88	Cinnamon Toast Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
89	Maple Pecan Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
90	Bourbon Brown Sugar Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
91	Vanilla Bean Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
92	Lemon Sugar Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
93	Strawberry Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
94	Raspberry & Rose Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
95	Blueberry Lemon Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
96	Orange Blossom & Honey Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
97	Cardamom & Brown Sugar Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
98	Apple Pie Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
99	Speculoos Spice Cookie Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√			√
100	Toasted Coconut & Lime Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
101	Banana Bread Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
102	Strawberry Vanilla Blueberry Layered Candle	Layered	√	√		√
103	Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
104	Milk Chocolate Hazelnut Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
105	White Chocolate & Raspberry Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
106	Mexican Hot Chocolate Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
107	Chocolate Orange Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
108	Mocha Espresso Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
109	Mint Chocolate Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
110	Chocolate Peanut Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
111	Salted Caramel Chocolate Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
112	S'mores Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√			√
113	Black Forest Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
114	Chocolate Chai Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
115	Pistachio White Chocolate Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		
116	Triple Chocolate Layered Candle	Layered	√	√		√
117	Classic Plant Butter Candle	Direct Wick	√	√	√	√
118	Herbed Olive Oil Candle	Poured	√	√	√	√
119	Roasted Garlic & Rosemary Plant Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
120	Nutritional Yeast "Parmesan" & Black Pepper Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
121	Smoky Maple Coconut "Bacon" Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	
122	Miso-Sesame Plant Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√		√	√
123	Dairy-Free Dark Chocolate Sea Salt Candle	Poured with Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
124	Cinnamon Maple Plant Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
125	Lemon, Basil & Olive Oil Candle	Poured	√	√	√	√
126	Sun-Dried Tomato & Basil Plant Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
127	Golden Turmeric & Ginger Coconut Candle	Poured	√	√	√	
128	Pumpkin Spice Plant Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√	√	√
129	Sage, Cranberry & Orange Thanksgiving Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
130	Pumpkin Spice Brown Butter Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
131	Thanksgiving Stuffing Candle	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√

No.	Recipe	Method	V	GF	DF	NF
132	**Turkey-Day Herb Butter Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
133	**Gingerbread Spice Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
134	**Candy Cane White Chocolate Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
135	**Mulled Wine & Orange Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
136	**Eggnog Nutmeg Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
137	**Rosemary Christmas Tree Candle**	Clean-Burn Core (shaped)	√	√		√
138	**Christmas Morning Cranberry-Orange Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
139	**Champagne & Chive Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
140	**Gold-Leaf Truffle Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
141	**Lunar New Year Mandarin & Sesame Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√			√
142	**Red Velvet Valentine's Candle**	Clean-Burn Core (shaped)	√	√		√
143	**Rose & Pink Peppercorn Heart Candle**	Direct Wick (shaped)	√	√		
144	**Hot Cross Bun Spice Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
145	**Honey Lavender Brunch Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
146	**Backyard BBQ Rub Candle**	Direct Wick	√	√		√
147	**Elote Street Corn Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
148	**Midnight Black Halloween Candle**	Clean-Burn Core		√		√
149	**Birthday Cake Sprinkle Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√
150	**Buffalo Wing Game Day Candle**	Clean-Burn Core	√	√		√

V = Vegetarian · GF = Gluten-Free · DF = Dairy-Free · NF = Nut-Free

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About the Author

Margot Ellery is a home cook and dinner-party host who believes the best part of any gathering is the moment everyone reaches for the same loaf. Holiday tables, birthday spreads and last-minute dinners with friends taught her that guests remember one thing above all: the dish that made them stop and stare. Edible candles became that dish, but her first attempts slumped, cracked and smoked. So she did what home cooks do: she tested, adjusted and wrote everything down. *The First-Try Edible Candle Cookbook* is the result, with every recipe written to work the first time.

Thank You

Thank you for cooking from this book. If one of these candles made your table brighter, I'd be so grateful if you'd take a moment to leave a short review on Amazon. Reviews help other home cooks find the book, and I read every one.